NexKit
GLOBAL

ETHIOPIA EDITION
GLOBAL EDITION · FIRST EDITION · SEPTEMBER 2026

THE PHONE-FIRST EDITION

04

The Social Media Manager Starter Course

How to Start a Social Media Management Business With Almost No Money

Audit a local business, fix its pages, and sell a monthly package that keeps paying.

30-day content calendar | 14 outreach scripts | Monthly packages

undefined	undefined	undefined
UNDEFINED	UNDEFINED	UNDEFINED

GLOBAL EDITION · FIRST EDITION · SEPTEMBER 2026

The Social Media Manager Starter Course

How to Start a Social Media Management Business With Almost No Money

LEGAL, DISCLAIMER AND HOW TO READ THIS

Copyright & Disclaimer

The Social Media Manager Starter Course — First Edition · September 2026

Publisher: NexKit your country Editorial Team. This course was written, edited and checked against published sources by the NexKit your country Editorial Team. It is not attributed to any individual author, and no personal credentials, photographs, earnings proof or biographies are presented anywhere in it.

What this course is

A practical, your country-specific operating manual for running the social media of a small local business as a paid monthly service. It covers how to choose which businesses are worth approaching, how to audit a page from a phone in twenty minutes, what to post for an local audience, how to plan thirty days of content in one sitting, how to shoot and edit on a phone with a small data bundle, how to write captions and scripts, how to use Telegram, how to report to a client and keep them, how to price a monthly package in dollars, and exactly what to say when you walk in or send a message.

Every number, fee, platform rule and statistic in this course is traceable to a published source listed in the Sources & Further Reading section at the back, or it is clearly labelled as an example.

What this course is not

It is not a promise of income. It does not guarantee that you will find a client, keep a client, or earn any specific amount. It cannot make a business succeed, and it cannot make a page grow on demand.

It is not legal, tax, accounting, financial or investment advice. It cannot tell you what a platform, a bank, a wallet provider or a government office will decide about your particular case. Those decisions depend on your documents, your record and the rules in force on the day you ask.

FINANCIAL AND LEGAL DISCLAIMER

Nothing in this course is a guarantee of income, clients, results or platform approval. Every money figure is either a published statistic with a source, or an **example to adjust to your own market and experience**. The price examples in dollars are teaching illustrations, not recommended rates and not a forecast of what anyone will pay you.

You are responsible for complying with local law, your tax obligations, the terms of service of every platform you use, and the requirements of any payment provider, wallet or bank you receive money through. This course is educational material only. It is not financial, legal, tax or investment advice, and it does not replace advice from a qualified professional or from the responsible office.

EXAMPLES ARE FICTIONAL

Every business named in this course is invented to teach a method and is labelled **Example scenario — fictional**. Client pages, audit findings, captions, prices, reports and messages are all illustrations. No real, recognisable local company appears here as a customer, a case study or a result.

CURRENCY, DATES AND VERIFICATION

Figures cited in this course are current as of **September 2026** unless a specific date is printed beside the figure. Source URLs for every statistic appear in the Sources & Further Reading section at the back of this course. Where this course could not verify a fact, it says so in the text and tells you to check it yourself before you rely on it.

Platform rules, free-plan limits, payment fees and country availability change often. Free tools mentioned in this course — including a free design tool, a free AI chat tool where available, Meta Business Suite, and free video editors such as CapCut, InShot and VN Editor — may change what they give away. Verify the current limits before you build a paid service on top of any tool.

Last updated: September 2026. Questions or corrections: use the contact address supplied with your purchase.

What is inside this course

01 · Which local Businesses Actually Need This, and Which Do Not 8
02 · The Audit: Your Free Foot in the Door 13
03 · Content Strategy That Fits a Small local Business 19
04 · The Content Calendar and the Content Bank 24
05 · Mobile-First, Low-Data Production 29
06 · Captions, Graphics and Short Video That Get Engagement 35
07 · Telegram, the Underrated Channel 41
08 · Reporting and Retention 47
09 · Packages and Pricing in Dollars 52
10 · Prospecting, Outreach and Onboarding 58

HOW TO WORK THROUGH THIS COURSE

Skim the section dividers first so you can see the whole route. Then work one section at a time and finish the **DO** tasks before moving to the next. The scripts, templates and checklists are meant to be copied, filled in and sent — not admired.

FRONT MATTER

Before You Start

This course teaches one job: running the social media of a small local business as a paid monthly service, from a phone, with no clients, no agency, no team and no budget.

What this course can help you do

— Judge which small local businesses will pay and which will waste six weeks.

— Audit a page from your phone in twenty minutes and deliver three specific improvements.

— Plan thirty days of content in one sitting using five pillars that fit local customers.

— Shoot, edit, compress and publish from a phone on a small bundle.

— Write captions, graphics and short video a local audience responds to.

— Price three monthly packages in dollars and keep a client past month three.

— Find forty prospects and send fourteen copy-ready scripts.

What this course cannot do. It cannot get you a client, make a business succeed, or make a page grow on demand. It cannot promise followers, reach, engagement or income. There is no published local rate card for this work and this course will not invent one — every price is an example to adjust.

What you need

— **An Android phone.** Everything here works on one.

— **A free design tool and a free video editor.** CapCut, InShot and VN Editor were all live on the Play Store with free tiers in September 2026. Free plans change — verify the current limits before you promise a client anything.

— **A free AI chat tool, where available,** for drafting captions. Optional. Never paste a client's customer data into a tool you do not trust.

— **Meta Business Suite** (free) for a Facebook Page and linked Instagram account, and **Telegram**, the channel local businesses already use.

— **A Google account** for Maps prospecting and a client's business listing. Google Business Profile lists your country as supported — verify before you promise.

— **A data bundle.** A 2 GB monthly bundle was around $0.60 on an indicative published guide. Safaricom your country raised mobile data prices by an average of about 44% in December 2025; Ethio telecom held low-income bundles unchanged. Check your own operator.

Time you actually need: about **90 minutes a day for 30 days**, roughly 45 hours. Enough to learn the job, build sample work, list forty prospects and send outreach. Not enough to guarantee a client, because nothing is. If that is unrealistic, use the five-hour fast path below.

THE MOST IMPORTANT RULE

Do not read this course without doing it. This is delivery work, not knowledge work. One audited business is worth more than three sections read. Every day you read, do one thing that touches a real business: open a real page, write a real audit, send a real message, publish a real post.

Two rules protect you. **Never take money for work you cannot deliver** — if you cannot shoot video yet, sell a package without video. And **never promise a result you do not control.** You control posting, answering and looking alive. You do not control the algorithm, the client's prices, or whether their food is good.

FRONT MATTER

Who This Is For, and Who It Is Not For

This is for you if

- You are roughly 20 to 35 and use Facebook, Instagram, TikTok and Telegram comfortably.
- You have run a page for yourself or a friend.
- You want a monthly service, not one-off design jobs.
- You have a phone, a bundle and about 90 minutes a day.
- You will walk into a shop or send a message a real person will read.
- You accept the first client may take four to eight weeks, and that some months you lose one.

This is not for you if

- You want to be paid for posting without answering messages. Half this job is the inbox.
- You want passive income. A retainer is a monthly obligation.
- You plan to buy followers. It breaches platform terms and any client who checks will find out.
- You want to promise a business it will go viral. Nobody can.
- You will not learn what the client actually sells. Generic captions lose accounts.

FRONT MATTER

How to Use This Course

Every workflow is written for a phone first. Where a laptop genuinely does the job better the step is marked LAPTOP; where a phone is fine, EITHER. Exactly one task really needs a laptop: heavy video editing.

LOW-DATA MODE

- Read and plan offline. This course is text-first on purpose.
- Draft captions in a notes file, then paste them in when you have signal.
- Compress before uploading. A 4 MB photo looks the same as a 400 KB one on a phone screen.
- Post outside 16:00–24:00 where you can. Published local reporting records freelancer speeds falling as low as 98 Kb/s in those hours.
- Keep one text-only backup post ready so a day without internet is still a day you published.

Impatient readers: read Sections 01, 02 and 10 first — who to approach, what to say, and what to do for thirty days.

FRONT MATTER

If You Only Have 5 Hours

Five hours, one sitting, today: the shortest honest path from zero to your first real conversation.

1. **Hour 1 — Read the market picture and Section 01**
   Choose three business types to target and two neighbourhoods you can reach on foot.
2. **Hour 2 — List 20 businesses**
   Google Maps, your first category, your first area, first twenty results: name, phone, page link, into a sheet.
3. **Hour 3 — Run 5 audits**
   Pick five with an active page, use the ten-point checklist in Section 02, and write the single worst problem for each.
4. **Hour 4 — Write one audit page and one message**
   Use the template in 2.4 and the delivery message in 2.6. Do not improve it. Finish it.
5. **Hour 5 — Send, walk, or call**
   Send to two businesses and visit one. Write down what happened.

The fast path skips strategy, production, Telegram, reporting and pricing. You will need Sections 03 to 09 the moment somebody says yes.

FRONT MATTER

The local Market Picture, Honestly

Understand the size of the room before you sell into it. These are published figures, sourced at the back of this course — and they are the reason your service is simple.

21.7%	9.80 m	1.55 m	1.80 m
OF LOCALS ONLINE — 29.5 M PEOPLE, 107 M OFFLINE	FACEBOOK AD REACH, 66.8% MALE	INSTAGRAM AD REACH	LINKEDIN MEMBERS, +38.5% Y/Y

Source: DataReportal Digital 2026: your country, listed in Sources & Further Reading.

Roughly four out of five locals are not online at all. This is not a market where a small business wins by going viral, because there is no giant audience to go viral to. It is a market where a business wins by being *findable*, *alive* and *answerable*. So you sell three boring, valuable things: a page that looks open rather than closed, messages that get answered, and correct hours, location and photos where people search.

> THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL SENTENCE IN THIS COURSE

Your client does not need viral. They need to look open, answer their messages, and be findable when somebody searches for what they sell. That is a service you can deliver on a phone, every week, forever.

THE CHURN WARNING — READ BEFORE YOU PLAN YOUR INCOME

local reporting found that **more than 80% of federal business licences issued went dormant during 2025.** Most small businesses here are not durable, continuous advertisers. Some will close, some will pause for three months, some will pay once and go quiet.

So do not build your income on one client and do not spend money you have not been paid. Plan for three to five clients, keep two conversations always open, and collect payment at the start of the month.

This says: "I have reviewed your page and prepared three improvements. There is no charge." Use it as a spoken opener, not a written one.

01

SECTION ONE

Which local Businesses Actually Need This, and Which Do Not

A sixteen-type table of the businesses that buy social media management — what they sell, what their pages look like, the problem you solve, whether they can pay monthly and how hard they are to sell to — followed by the counter-list of businesses that will not pay.

01 The test that separates a prospect from a waste of time

02 Sixteen business types, scored honestly

03 How to pick your first five

04 The counter-list: businesses that will not pay

05 Choosing your geographic patch

Every beginner approaches the businesses that are easiest to find instead of the ones most likely to pay. This section fixes that in one table.

1.1 The test that separates a prospect from a waste of time

EXPLAIN A business is a good prospect when **customers already use a phone to find or contact it**, when a visible monthly income would grow from a few extra customers, and when somebody can answer you quickly.

SHOW **Example — fictional.** A a regional city restaurant with a menu and 1,400 followers that last posted in March is a prospect. The single-room kiosk next door is not, and no audit will change that.

DO Mark the five types in 1.2 you can physically reach this week. Do not add a sixth until you have sent twenty messages.

CHECK For each of your five you can say in one sentence who finds them on a phone, what one extra customer a week is worth in dollars, and who you would talk to.

1.2 Sixteen business types, scored honestly

BUSINESS TYPE	WHAT THE PAGE USUALLY LOOKS LIKE	THE PROBLEM	PAYS MONTHLY? / HARD TO SELL
Restaurant	Phone food photos, occasional posts, comments unanswered	No prices or today's menu; weekend bookings arrive too late	Yes — daily cash, holiday peaks / Medium. Call 15:00–17:00
Café	Nice photos, no captions, no location tag, last post months ago	Nothing says where it is, when it opens or what it costs	Yes — steady cash / Easy. Owners are often young and online
Juice house	Reposted customer photos, no look, no delivery info	Strong product, invisible business; delivery goes to whoever posts daily	Yes, smaller amounts / Easy. Quick decisions
Beauty salon	Good before-and-after photos, posted irregularly, no booking instruction	DM bookings get lost; no price list means every enquiry costs a conversation	Yes — high-ticket services / Easy. They know looks sell
Barbershop	TikTok clips, irregular posting, no prices, no queue system	Customers cannot tell the wait, the price, or whether it is open now	Yes, small budgets / Easy. Video-friendly

BUSINESS TYPE	WHAT THE PAGE USUALLY LOOKS LIKE	THE PROBLEM	PAYS MONTHLY? / HARD TO SELL
Clothing store	Stock on hangers, no sizes, no prices, "how much?" unanswered	Every sale needs a private chat; the page creates work instead of orders	Yes — monthly stock turnover / Easy. Responds to a price card
Shoe shop	Hand-written prices in the image, no stock updates	Customers arrive for sizes sold out weeks ago, or do not come	Yes, moderate / Medium. Often family-run, cautious

BUSINESS TYPE	WHAT THE PAGE USUALLY LOOKS LIKE	THE PROBLEM	PAYS MONTHLY? / HARD TO SELL
Real-estate agent	Listings cross-posted to groups, no interiors, no price	Buyers cannot tell listings apart; the agent re-explains each one fifty times	Yes — commission, high value per deal / Medium to hard

BUSINESS TYPE	WHAT THE PAGE USUALLY LOOKS LIKE	THE PROBLEM	PAYS MONTHLY? / HARD TO SELL
Gym	Motivational quotes and stock photos, no real members, no timetable	Prospects cannot see equipment, timetable or price, so they never visit	Yes — memberships suit monthly fees / Medium. Seasonal

BUSINESS TYPE	WHAT THE PAGE USUALLY LOOKS LIKE	THE PROBLEM	PAYS MONTHLY? / HARD TO SELL
Clinic	Sparse and cautious; sometimes just a logo and an address	Patients do not know the services, hours, or whether a specialist is in	Yes — steady patient flow / Hard to open, loyal once won. No health claims
Pharmacy	Almost nothing, or occasional new-stock posts	Nobody knows it delivers, opens early, or has a specific item	Yes, tight margins / Medium. Hours, location and service only
Small retailer	Product photos with a phone number overlaid, old prices never removed	Customers cannot trust the price list and call to check every item	Yes, if stock moves / Easy. Responds to a price card
Construction business	Site photos with no context, no finished-project gallery	Cannot demonstrate quality; buyers choose whoever looks like they finish	Yes, but irregular / Medium. One project justifies a package
Tour operator	Beautiful photographs, no prices, no itinerary, slow replies	Loses foreign and diaspora enquiries to operators who answer in minutes	Yes, sometimes in FX / Easy. Expects professionalism

BUSINESS TYPE	WHAT THE PAGE USUALLY LOOKS LIKE	THE PROBLEM	PAYS MONTHLY? / HARD TO SELL
Hotel or guesthouse	Room photos, no rates, no availability, date questions unanswered	Direct bookings lost to sites that take commission	Yes — operating budget / Medium. Two approvals expected

BUSINESS TYPE	WHAT THE PAGE USUALLY LOOKS LIKE	THE PROBLEM	PAYS MONTHLY? / HARD TO SELL
Photographer	Good images after events, silence between, no packages	Cannot show range; buyers assume one kind of work	Yes, seasonal but real / Easy. Already a content producer

BUSINESS TYPE	WHAT THE PAGE USUALLY LOOKS LIKE	THE PROBLEM	PAYS MONTHLY? / HARD TO SELL
Tutor or learning centre	Results announcements, no timetable, no fees, no enrolment steps	Parents cannot compare or enrol without three phone calls	Yes — termly fees / Easy. Education inflation has been hot
Event planner	Albums of past events, no packages, no price bands	Every enquiry starts from zero; silence between events looks closed	Yes, irregular and seasonal / Medium. Strong visuals help

General patterns typical of these business types, not survey data. Verify against the real pages in your own city — that is what Section 02 is for.

1.3 How to pick your first five

Do not pick the biggest budgets. Pick businesses where **one visible improvement produces one visible result**, because your first client is also your first proof. Start with cafés, juice houses, barbershops, beauty salons, clothing shops and small retail: small, fast decisions, and the owner is the person you meet. Work up to clinics, pharmacies, hotels, construction and real estate, where approvals take longer but one customer is worth far more.

THE THREE-SIGNAL TEST YOU CAN RUN IN NINETY SECONDS

One: has it posted in the last 30 days? **Two:** is there a phone number, address or location pin anywhere? **Three:** is there any reply from the business to a comment or question? Two out of three and it is worth twenty minutes. Zero out of three and you are looking at a business that has not decided to be online yet.

1.4 The counter-list: businesses that will not pay

DO NOT SPEND YOUR MONTH HERE

— **Single-owner kiosks and small shops with no phone-based customers.** The owner is the only worker and there is no monthly margin for a service.

— **Brand-new shops that have not opened.** No customers, no photos, no cash flow. Come back in three months.

— **Businesses with no phone-based customers at all.** Their money is better spent on a sign.

— **Businesses that do not answer their own phone.** They will not answer the customers your posts bring either.

— **Businesses in an active dispute, closure or mourning period.** Read the room and walk past.

— **Anyone offering exposure or a share of profit instead of a fee.** Exposure does not pay for data.

1.5 Choosing your geographic patch

Beginners cover a whole city and reach nobody. Choose a patch you can walk in one afternoon. **In your city,** the ten sub-cities are the commercial district, the central district, the eastern district, the old town, the northern district, the western district, the outer district, the industrial district, the market district and the busiest district. Pick two. the commercial district and the central district have the most cafés, salons and offices; the eastern district and the northern district are quieter with less competition for your attention; the old town and the busiest district are dense trading areas where pages are usually untouched.

In a regional city, the method is identical with less competition. a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city and a regional city all have hotels, restaurants, clinics, learning centres and shops with neglected pages, and a walk-in carries more weight than a message.

My three target business types .....

My two neighbourhoods or sub-cities .....

Prospects I will list this week .....

02

SECTION TWO

The Audit: Your Free Foot in the Door

A ten-point audit you can run from a phone in twenty minutes, the one-page document it produces, a full worked example for a fictional the commercial district café, and the copy-ready message that delivers it.

01 Why the audit works better than a pitch

02 The ten-point checklist

03 The twenty-minute timer

04 The one-page deliverable

05 Worked example: a fictional the commercial district café

06 Copy-ready delivery messages

You cannot sell social media management by describing it. Nobody has ever bought "we will handle your digital presence". They buy a specific problem they can see.

2.1 Why the audit works better than a pitch

EXPLAIN A pitch says "hire me". An audit says "here is what I found". The second is almost impossible to be annoyed by, and it proves competence faster than any claim, because the owner can check every point in ten seconds.

SHOW **Example — fictional.** Instead of "Selam, I do social media management, do you need help?", you send: "Your profile photo shows the old shopfront, your last three posts have no prices, and twenty-two comments asking for the price are unanswered. I wrote a one-page note with three fixes. Want it?" One of those gets a reply.

DO Audit three businesses today and do not contact them yet. Build a stock of door-openers instead of sending one desperate message.

CHECK Every line can be verified by the owner in under a minute. If you cannot point to the exact post or comment, do not write it.

> **THE RULE OF THE FREE AUDIT**
>
> One page, three improvements, no price list, no invoice, no obligation. It is a gift with a boundary. Never turn the free audit into a free strategy document, content calendar or design.

2.2 The ten-point checklist

Points one to four are what a customer sees first; five to ten are what makes them stay.

#	WHAT YOU CHECK	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE	WHAT TO WRITE
1	**Profile photo and page name**	Clear logo or good shopfront photo; name exactly as customers say it, with the area	Name the specific problem: blurred snapshot, old shopfront, wrong area
2	**Bio and contact details**	One line on what they sell, one phone, one location, one opening line	Each missing field is a lost customer you can name
3	**Last post date**	Within seven days for food or retail	Give the exact date. "Last post: 14 March." A date is evidence
4	**Posting frequency**	Three to five posts a week, steady, not in bursts	Count the posts in the last 30 days and write the number
5	**Photo quality**	Daylight, simple background, product filling the frame, no flash glare	Name it: dark, blurred, cluttered background, flash reflection
6	**Caption quality**	A first line that says something, a reason to care, an instruction	Quote one weak caption exactly, then rewrite it in one line
7	**Response to comments and DMs**	Every question answered, ideally the same day	Count unanswered questions. "Eleven comments asking the price, none answered"
8	**Use of local language**	the local language, or a mix, matching how customers actually speak	If every post is English for the local language-speaking neighbourhood, say so

#	WHAT YOU CHECK	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE	WHAT TO WRITE
9	**Prices, hours, location visible**	Findable in under ten seconds without asking	If a customer must ask, count how many steps it takes

#	WHAT YOU CHECK	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE	WHAT TO WRITE
10	**Call to action**	One clear next step: call, message, order, visit, reserve	No instruction means no action. Write the line you would add

2.3 The twenty-minute timer

1. **Minutes 0–3 — Find and open the page**

   Search the name on Facebook, then Instagram, then check Google Maps. Open it **on a phone**, because that is how customers see it.

2. **Minutes 3–6 — Points 1 to 4**

   Screenshot the profile photo and bio. Write the date of the most recent post. Count posts in the last 30 days.

3. **Minutes 6–11 — Points 5 to 7**

   Look at the last nine posts. Judge the photographs honestly. Count questions in the comments with no reply — usually the finding that closes the sale.

4. **Minutes 11–15 — Points 8 to 10**

   Check the language mix. Find the price, hours and location without asking anybody, and time yourself.

5. **Minutes 15–20 — Write the one page**

   Three improvements in priority order, each with the exact change. Not "improve photos" but "reshoot the six menu items by the window on Saturday morning, one item per photo".

DO NOT WRITE THESE IN AN AUDIT

— Anything about the owner's competence or effort. Describe the page, never the person.

— Numbers you cannot show. "You are losing 100 customers a month" is invented. "Eleven people asked the price and got no answer" is countable.

— Comparisons with named competitors, or guarantees, or more than three recommendations.

2.4 The one-page deliverable

THE TEMPLATE — SIX SECTIONS, ONE PAGE

1. **Business name and date.** "Audit prepared for [business] on [date]."
2. **What is already working.** Two or three true, specific positives.
3. **The three things costing you customers.** Three findings in priority order, each with the exact post date or screenshot as evidence.
4. **What I would do first.** Three matching actions, each with a time estimate in hours, so the work looks small.
5. **What I am not saying.** "I have not looked at your advertising, your prices or your competitors. This is only what a customer sees on your page."
6. **Contact.** Your name, phone, one line on what you do. No price, no pressure.

Send a **view-only Google Doc link**, not a PDF and never a Word file. Links open instantly on a weak connection; attachments get left unread.

2.5 Worked example: a fictional the commercial district café

Example scenario — fictional. the commercial district Beans Café is invented for teaching. The findings are the kind you will find on real pages every week.

WORKED AUDIT — THE COMMERCIAL DISTRICT BEANS CAFÉ

Page audit — the commercial district Beans Café. Prepared by [your name] on [date], reviewed from a phone the way your customers see it.

What is already working. 1,840 Facebook and 610 Instagram followers, more than most cafés in the area — people found you once and chose to follow. The avocado toast posted on 3 August is genuinely good: bright, food filling the frame, 96 reactions. And you post in both the local language and English, which matches how your customers in the commercial district actually speak.

1. Your last post was 11 April, four months ago. A customer who finds your page today cannot tell whether you are still open; in this area an inactive page reads as a closed shop. Nothing else you fix will matter while the page looks abandoned.

2. Eleven people asked the price of the breakfast platter and nobody answered — six on your most recent post, five on the one before. Each of them chose your café over the others on that street, asked a question, and heard nothing. Some went somewhere else that afternoon.

3. Nothing on the page says where you are, when you open or what you cost. No address in the bio, opening hours nowhere, and the coffee price only visible by zooming into a photo of the menu board taken at an angle.

What I would do first. 1) Restart posting with three posts a week, starting this week — about 45 minutes a week once the photos exist; the first post should be the room at 8am with the opening hours in the caption. 2) Answer every comment and message the same day, even with one line — about 10 minutes a day, and the fastest thing on this list to fix. 3) Put the address, hours and three prices in the bio and on a pinned post — about one hour, once.

What I am not saying. I have not looked at your advertising, your menu prices or your competitors. I am not promising that fixing these will increase your sales — I am saying these are the three things I would change first.

Contact. [your name] · [phone]. I help local businesses in [area] keep their pages active and answer their customers. No obligation — if you want to use this list yourself, please do.

Notice what that audit does. Real credit first. Countable evidence — dates, comment numbers, follower numbers. Three things, not ten. Time estimates so the work looks small. Its own limits stated. And a last line that genuinely gives the advice away, which is why it works: an owner who reads "if you want to use this list yourself, please do" stops feeling sold to, and starts wondering what else you would notice.

2.6 Copy-ready delivery messages

DELIVERY MESSAGE 1 — FACEBOOK OR INSTAGRAM DM

Selam [owner's name]. I looked at the [business name] page on my phone this week and wrote a one-page note about what a customer sees.

Three things, in priority order, with what I would change first. No charge and no obligation: [view-only link]

If it is useful, tell me and I will explain the rest. If not, no problem at all, and I will not keep messaging you.

DELIVERY MESSAGE 2 — TELEGRAM

Selam. My name is [your name]. I help businesses in [area] with their pages.

I audited [business name] this week: profile, posts, comments, price visibility. The biggest finding is that your last post was [date] and [number] price questions have no reply.

Want me to send the page? It is free and there is nothing to sign.

DELIVERY MESSAGE 3 — AFTER A WALK-IN VISIT

Selam [owner's name], thank you for the two minutes today. Here is the one-page note I mentioned: [link].

The short version: the page has not posted since [month], and there are [number] unanswered questions in the comments.

If you want me to handle it, tell me and I will explain how it works. If you would rather do it yourself, the note is yours.

This says: "I looked at your page on my phone and noticed three points. There is no charge." Say it once in person, then stop talking and let the owner respond.

2.7 What to do after you send it

If they reply positively: answer within an hour if you can, because speed demonstrates the service. Ask "which of the three do you want handled first?" and let them choose the entry point. Then present the package (Section 09) — never put a price in the same message as the audit.

If they say nothing: wait three days and send "just checking the note arrived — no rush". Wait a week and send one more with a new finding, then stop. Put them in a "revisit in 60 days" list, because businesses change their minds when a slow season ends.

AUDIT FIVE A DAY AND YOU WILL NOT NEED TO GUESS

Five audits is about 100 minutes. In one week you have twenty-five businesses, each with a real document and a real finding. Most readers who fail at this stage do not fail at the audit — they fail by doing three and then stopping.

03

SECTION THREE

Content Strategy That Fits a Small local Business

The five content pillars that work locally, how local holidays and fasting seasons change what a business should post, the discipline of confirming dates with the client every year, and a one-page strategy template.

01 Why strategy is short here

02 The five pillars: product, people, place, proof, offer

03 The the local calendar rhythm

04 The one-page strategy template

A strategy for a small local business fits on one page. Anything longer is a document you will never open again, and neither will the client.

3.1 Why strategy is short here

EXPLAIN Strategy for a small business is not a market analysis. It is one page answering four questions: who are we talking to, what do we want them to do, what will we post about, how often. Everything else is decoration a single-owner business will never read.

SHOW **Example — fictional.** Lakeview Style House: "We talk to women aged 22 to 40 in a regional city who buy two or three new outfits a year. We want them to message us for a size. We post product, people, place, proof and offer, three times a week. Every caption ends with the Telegram link." Eleven minutes to write, and it works.

DO Write the strategy page for one real prospect before you contact them. Bring it to the first meeting as a draft so the owner has something concrete to correct.

CHECK The owner can read it in under two minutes and disagree with at least one line. If they agree with everything instantly, you wrote something too vague to be wrong.

3.2 The five pillars

Five pillars cover everything a small local business needs to post, and they solve the blank page. When you do not know what to post, rotate through them and the answer is already there.

01 Product

What they sell, shown clearly. Food on a plate, a dress on a body, a room made up. Prices visible where the owner allows it. **Why:** ordering decisions here are made from a photograph. **Frequency:** two of every five posts.

02 People

The owner, the staff, a regular customer, a person doing the work. **Why:** customers buy from people they recognise, and a face turns a page into a place they have been. **Frequency:** one in five.

03 Place

The shopfront, the street, the inside, the corner where people sit. Location, hours, which minibus stops nearby. **Why:** most customers are local, and knowing where a place is and whether it is open now beats any clever caption. **Frequency:** one in five.

04 Proof

Evidence the business does what it claims. A finished order, a customer reaction, a review screenshot with the name covered. **Why:** it answers the question every buyer asks silently — has anyone else done this and been happy? **Frequency:** one in five, and the most under-used pillar locally.

05 Offer

A specific, time-limited reason to act now. A set-menu price, a graduation package, free delivery over a certain amount. **Why:** an offer gives the customer permission to stop thinking and act. **Frequency:** one in five at most — a page that only posts offers trains customers to wait for a discount.

THE ROTATION, IN ONE LINE

For a three-posts-a-week client: **Product, Proof, People** in week one; **Product, Place, Offer** in week two; then repeat. Twenty-six posts from one rotation, and about four minutes to plan a week once the photographs exist.

3.3 The the local calendar rhythm

Content that ignores the local calendar looks foreign and lands badly. This is one of the few places where a local freelancer has a real advantage over a foreign agency.

CONFIRM THE DATES WITH THE CLIENT, EVERY YEAR

Do not build a fixed holiday calendar and reuse it. Fasting periods and some holidays follow a lunar calendar, so dates move each year, and different communities mark some days differently. The owner knows their own customers better than any guide.

In the first week of every contract, sit with the client and ask three things — which holidays bring the most customers, which fasting seasons change what you sell, and which days should we not post at all. Date the page and re-confirm it every year.

SEASON	WHAT CHANGES	WHAT TO POST	WHAT TO AVOID
Ramadan and Eid	Customers fast by day and buy heavily in the evening; hours shift rather than trade falling	Iftar timing, evening hours, family platters, delivery windows, gifts before Eid	Food photos during the fasting day with no context; a lunch offer nobody wants at 13:00
The Lenten fast	A long meat-free season; restaurants that adapt keep trading, those that do not lose weeks	Fasting menus with prices and the specific dishes, and reassurance the kitchen is fully fasting	Meat and dairy promotions; one buried "we also have fasting food" line
a religious holiday	The fast breaks: family gatherings, new clothes, big meals, one of the biggest spending weeks	Pre-orders with a stated deadline, family portions, holiday hours, clothing and gifts	Starting two days before — pre-orders need two weeks of notice
a national holiday	Flowers, gatherings, family visits; strong for food, drink and clothing	Gathering offers, delivery, group bookings, traditional dishes for the day	Missing the season with generic content. It is a short, sharp peak
new year	New clothes, gifts, cards, family visits, a strong photography season	Gift ideas, new stock, greetings using the business's own photographs	Borrowed greeting images with another business's logo still visible

SEASON	WHAT CHANGES	WHAT TO POST	WHAT TO AVOID
a religious festival	Large public gatherings, processions, visitors from out of town, early mornings	Opening hours around the celebration, what will be available, how to get there	Loud commercial offers during a religious observance. Sell quietly
a religious holiday	Family meals, gifts, travel; a peak for hospitality and retail	Pre-orders, family packages, opening hours, delivery cut-off dates	An empty calendar through the busiest fortnight of the year

SEASON	WHAT CHANGES	WHAT TO POST	WHAT TO AVOID
Graduation season	Photographers, tailors, salons, restaurants and gift sellers peak at once; it moves with the university calendar	Booking deadlines, packages, price bands, finished-work proof from last year	Assuming the dates instead of confirming them with the client

SEASON	WHAT CHANGES	WHAT TO POST	WHAT TO AVOID
Rainy and quiet weeks	Foot traffic drops; delivery and indoor offers matter more	Delivery, indoor offers, comfort food, slower warmer content	Pretending nothing changed — customers notice a page out of step with the weather

General patterns only. Dates move, observance varies, and the client's own knowledge is the authority.

3.4 Three questions that keep you accurate all year

1. **Ask what they sell differently this season**

   "What do people buy from you now that they do not buy in other months?" That answer is your content plan for eight weeks.

2. **Ask when the rush actually starts**

   Not the holiday date, but the date customers start ordering. For pre-orders, catering and tailoring that is usually two to three weeks earlier.

3. **Ask which days to stay quiet**

   "Are there days you would rather I did not post?" Getting this wrong once is the fastest way to lose a client's trust.

3.5 The one-page strategy template

Fill this in for every client. Keep it to one page, share it as a view-only link, and update it once a quarter.

Business name and area .....

What they sell, in one line .....

Who buys, in one line .....

The one action we want customers to take .....

Platforms, in priority order .....

Posts per week .....

PILLAR	WHAT WE WILL POST	WHO PROVIDES THE MATERIAL	HOW OFTEN
Product			
People			
Place			

PILLAR	WHAT WE WILL POST	WHO PROVIDES THE MATERIAL	HOW OFTEN
Proof			

PILLAR	WHAT WE WILL POST	WHO PROVIDES THE MATERIAL	HOW OFTEN
Offer			

Key season 1 and its start date .....

Key season 2 and its start date .....

Days we will not post .....

Date confirmed with the client .....

THE SENTENCE THAT MAKES THE STRATEGY CREDIBLE

Put this at the bottom of every strategy page: **"This plan is a draft. You know your customers better than I do — tell me what is wrong and I will change it."** It costs nothing, it is true, and clients who help write the plan are far harder to lose.

04

SECTION FOUR

The Content Calendar and the Content Bank

How to plan thirty days in one sitting, the three-block batching method that produces a month of material in a single day, a full illustrative thirty-day calendar for a fictional café, and the blank template you copy into Google Sheets.

01 Why batching beats daily posting

02 The three-block batch day

03 The thirty-day calendar, worked through

04 Building the content bank

05 The blank calendar and its column headers

The biggest difference between a freelancer who quits in month two and one still working in month twelve is not talent. It is whether they batch.

4.1 Why batching beats daily posting

EXPLAIN Batching means doing one kind of work many times in one session. Instead of shooting, editing, writing and posting every day, you shoot twenty photographs in one morning, film six videos in one afternoon, and write thirty captions in one evening. It is faster because your camera is already out and your head is already in the task.

SHOW **Example — fictional.** A fictional a regional city juice house in one weekend: Saturday morning, twenty product photographs in 90 minutes. Saturday afternoon, six 15-second clips. Sunday evening, thirty captions from those assets. A month of content for one client in about six hours.

DO Block one morning this week. It does not need to be for a paying client — batch a sample month for a fictional business in your category, label it, and use it as portfolio and practice.

CHECK After your batch you can name the exact number of assets: photographs, clips, captions. If the answer is a feeling rather than a number, you did not batch — you just took some pictures.

THE MATHS THAT MAKES THIS A BUSINESS

EXAMPLE TIME BUDGET — ONE CLIENT, ONE MONTH

```
Batch day (shoot, film, caption): 6 h
Weekly inbox and replies: 4 × 25 min = 1 h 40 m
Calendar, report, client call: 2 h
Total: about 10 hours per client per month
```

Arithmetic on an example workload, not a promise. Your first two months will be longer.

4.2 The three-block batch day

1. **Block 1 — One morning photographing twenty product shots**

   Go early, between 8:00 and 10:00, or late afternoon, and use daylight near a window or the open door. Never use the flash on food or glass. Set up one plain surface — a clean table, a white cloth, a wooden board — and shoot everything on it so the month looks consistent.

   Shot list: five hero shots (one item filling the frame), four group shots, two wides of the room, one shopfront in daylight, one signboard close-up, two staff at work, two customer moments with permission, one detail shot (hands, steam, texture), two seasonal items.

1. **Block 2 — One afternoon filming six short videos**

   Film vertical, never horizontal. Keep the phone steady against a wall or with both elbows on a table. Film each clip three times; the third take is usually the one you use.

   The six clips: a 15-second product demo (pouring, plating, folding), a 30-second behind-the-scenes (the kitchen at 7am), a 20-second customer reaction with permission, a 15-second tour of the place, a 20-second owner introduction to camera, and a 15-second walk from the nearest landmark to the door. Record the real sound where you can — ambient kitchen noise and a real voice are more convincing than music and cost no data.

1 **Block 3 — One evening writing thirty captions**

Write them all in one notes file, offline if the connection is weak. Never write in the app — you will lose them when it closes. Number each caption to match the asset file name, so publishing is copy, paste, attach, done.

The thirty: twelve product, six proof, six people, four place, two offer — matching the pillar rotation, with two spares for a holiday or a quiet week.

BATCH-DAY RULES THAT SAVE YOU LATER

— **Get permission before photographing anyone.** A message that says yes is enough. Never photograph children without a parent's clear agreement.

— **Do not promise twelve posts when you have material for nine.** Count your assets before you agree a number.

— **Back up the batch twice** — a folder on the phone and one free cloud folder.

— **Leave the last week of the month partly unplanned,** so you can react to a holiday, a new item or a rainy week.

4.3 The thirty-day calendar, worked through

Example scenario — fictional. the commercial district Beans Café, three posts a week. Two spare rows, because a month has gaps and you will want them.

DAY	PILLAR	FORMAT	CAPTION ANGLE	ASSET NEEDED
Mon 1	Product	Single photo	The breakfast platter, price in the caption	Hero shot of the platter
Wed 3	Place	Photo + location tag	Where we are: two minutes from the main road, opening hours	Shopfront in morning light
Fri 5	Offer	Price card	Two coffees and a pastry before 10am, this week only	Text graphic plus one product photo
Mon 8	People	Single photo	The person who roasts every morning	Staff at work, hands and beans
Wed 10	Product	15-second video	Pouring a macchiato, real sound, no music	Demo clip, vertical
Fri 12	Proof	Screenshot	What a customer wrote about the shakshuka, name covered	Message screenshot, cropped
Mon 15	Product	Carousel of 3	Three juices, three prices, one caption	Three product shots
Wed 17	Place	Single photo	The corner where people work on laptops, and the sockets	Wide shot of the seating area
Fri 19	Proof	20-second video	A full room on a Friday evening, filmed from the door	Customer-moment clip, permission confirmed

DAY	PILLAR	FORMAT	CAPTION ANGLE	ASSET NEEDED
Mon 22	People	Single photo	A regular who has come every morning for two years	Customer portrait, permission confirmed
Wed 24	Product	Single photo	The fasting platter, clearly labelled, price included	Seasonal item shot
Fri 26	Offer	Text graphic	Pre-order a family portion for the holiday, deadline stated	Text graphic plus one wide shot
Mon 29	Proof	Carousel of 3	Three photographs from our busiest week	Three candid shots
Wed 31	Place	15-second video	How to find us from the nearest landmark, walking	Walk-to-shop clip, vertical

Twelve published posts is the right target for a three-a-week client; two rows are spares. Adjust all of this to the client's own busy season.

THE MIX, COUNTED

Product **5** · Proof **4** · Place **4** · People **2** · Offer **3**. People is deliberately light here because a café relies on its food photographs. A salon would flip it: mostly proof and people. Count the mix at the end of planning and correct anything that has drifted.

4.4 Building the content bank

Evergreen reserve

Ten posts that are always true: the shopfront, the hours, the location, the owner's story, the most popular item, how delivery works. **Use when** you are ill, travelling, or the client goes quiet.

Seasonal reserve

Six posts prepared for the season you confirmed with the client: fasting menu, holiday pre-order, back-to-school, graduation. **Use when** the season starts earlier than you planned.

Text-only reserve

Five posts that are pure text: an announcement, an hours change, a thank-you, a question to customers, a reminder. **Use when** the internet is down and you cannot upload an image at all.

Store the bank in two places: a folder on your phone and one free cloud folder. Name every file so you can find it without opening it — `bolebeans_product_platter_01.jpg`, not `IMG_20260912_114533.jpg`.

4.5 The blank calendar and its column headers

COPY-READY: THE EXACT COLUMN HEADERS

`Date | Day | Pillar | Format | Platform | Caption angle | Asset needed | Asset ready? | Status | Notes`

Date — when you plan to publish. **Day** — the weekday, so you see the shape of the week. **Pillar** — product, people, place, proof or offer. **Format** — single photo, carousel, 15-second video, text graphic, text only. **Platform** — Facebook, Instagram, TikTok or Telegram, in posting order. **Caption angle** — one line on what the caption is about, not the caption itself. **Asset needed** — exactly which photograph or clip. **Asset ready?** — yes or no. **Status** — planned, drafted, scheduled, published. **Notes** — anything the client asked for, or a season reminder.

THE TWO COLUMNS THAT DECIDE WHETHER THIS WORKS

Asset ready? and **Status**. Most beginners fill in a beautiful calendar and discover on the day that the photograph does not exist. Answering "Asset ready?" honestly at planning time shows you immediately which days need shooting before the month starts.

4.6 Your planning session, in order

1. **Put the client's fixed dates in first**
   Holidays, pre-order deadlines, a new menu, a sale, a closure. Everything else bends around them.
2. **Count backwards from each deadline**
   A pre-order closing on the 20th needs posts on the 6th, the 13th and the 18th.
3. **Fill the gaps with the pillar rotation**
   Product, proof, people, product, place, offer. Rotate until the month is full and the mix is balanced.
4. **Mark every asset you do not have**
   If nine rows need new photographs, your batch day has nine specific items on the shot list.
5. **Write the captions the same week, and share the plan**
   Captions written in advance are calmer and shorter. Send the calendar as a link and ask: "What is wrong in this plan?" One correction from the client beats an hour of your own guessing.

Month this calendar covers .....

Posts planned this month .....

Assets I still need to shoot .....

Next batch day .....

05

SECTION FIVE

Mobile-First, Low-Data Production

How to shoot on a phone so the photographs look professional, how to edit and compress before uploading, how to post around the hours when local mobile speeds collapse, what to do when the internet is down, and the honest answer about when a laptop is genuinely required.

01 The connectivity reality you work inside

02 Shooting on a phone

03 The 720p decision

04 Editing and compressing

05 Posting around the slow hours

06 When the internet is down

07 The honest answer about laptops

You do not need equipment. You need light, a plain background and steady hands. The rest of this section is about making sure the file actually reaches the customer.

5.1 The connectivity reality you work inside

9.37	26.63	98 Kb/s	16:00–24:00
MBPS MEDIAN FIXED DOWNLOAD	MBPS AVERAGE MOBILE DOWNLOAD	WORST-CASE FREELANCER SPEEDS	THE WORST HOURS OF THE DAY

Source: DataReportal and Addis Fortune reporting, listed in Sources & Further Reading. Averages hide a lot — plan for the low end.

EXPLAIN local mobile data is fast enough on average and unreliable at the worst moment. **98 Kb/s is roughly one fortieth of a healthy mobile connection**, and at that speed an uncompressed phone photograph takes minutes to upload while a one-minute video can fail entirely.

SHOW **Example — fictional.** A freelancer in a regional city finishes four posts at 19:40. Two images go through, the third stalls at 60%, the fourth fails. By 22:30 nothing more has moved. Next morning at 07:15 both upload in under a minute. Same files, same phone, different hour.

DO Prepare everything the evening before and publish between **06:00 and 09:00**. Where the platform allows it, schedule during the good hours in Meta Business Suite instead of posting live.

CHECK Keep a note of the hours when uploads actually succeed for you. After two weeks you have your own reliable window, which is worth more than any general advice.

5.2 Shooting on a phone

Daylight from a window or an open door is the only lighting you need. Put the product between the window and your phone so the light falls across it from the side. **Never use the flash on food, drinks or anything glossy** — it produces a flat white glare that makes fresh food look plastic. After dark, point the torch at the ceiling rather than the subject, or move the shoot to the morning. In a dark restaurant in the evening, move to the doorway and use the light from outside.

Pick one surface and use it all month — a clean table, a white cloth, a plain wall, coloured paper. Consistency is what makes a month of posts look like a brand rather than a camera roll, and cluttered backgrounds are the most common reason a small business's photographs look amateur. The fix costs nothing.

— **Tuck your elbows into your ribs** and hold the phone with both hands. This alone removes most blur.

— **Lean on something,** or rest the phone on a stack of books and use the timer.

— **Tap the screen where you want focus,** then drag the brightness slider down to enrich the image — the fix for most over-bright food photographs.

— **Move closer instead of zooming.** Digital zoom destroys detail. Step in until the product fills about three quarters of the frame.

— **Wipe the lens.** A fingerprint produces a soft haze no filter fixes.

— **Shoot three versions of everything** — wide, closer, closest — so you have the crops you need later.

> **PERMISSION AND PRIVACY — DO THIS PROPERLY**

> Do not photograph customers, staff or anyone else's property without asking. A short message that says yes is enough, and keep it. Never post a recognisable face without permission, never photograph children without a parent's clear agreement, and never photograph inside a private home, a clinic room or a place of worship without explicit permission. If a client asks you to post a customer's message as proof, cover the name and phone number first.

5.3 The 720p decision

720p vertical is what most people actually watch on a phone screen, on a moving minibus, on a small bundle, and the file is a fraction of 4K — so it uploads in the good hours instead of failing in the bad ones. It also edits faster, crashes less on a mid-range phone, and stores more cheaply.

1080p or higher is worth it in four cases: a client who wants the file for a screen or a paid advertisement; a hero shot that will be cropped hard; products where fine texture is the selling point; and anything the client asked to keep as an archive. **The practical rule:** shoot at the highest setting your phone and storage allow, then export and upload at 720p. Check the setting before the shoot, not after. Clear space first, because high-resolution video fills storage fast and can make a mid-range phone hot and slow during a batch.

5.4 Editing and compressing

The three editors most readers will already have are CapCut, InShot and VN Editor, all live on the Play Store with free tiers as of September 2026. **Free plans change — check the current limits before you build a client workflow on one.**

1. **Fix the photograph in five moves**

   1. Crop to the shape you need — square for feeds, vertical 9:16 for Reels, TikTok and Stories. **2. Straighten** if the table edge is tilted. **3. Brightness** up slightly. **4. Contrast** up slightly so the subject separates from the background. **5. Warmth** nudged up for food, never down. Stop there.

2. **Cut video to the shortest version that still makes sense**

   Fifteen seconds of pouring a macchiato beats ninety seconds of the whole morning. Cut the first two seconds of every clip, where you fumbled for the record button, and put the most interesting moment in the first three seconds.

3. **Use captions on video, always**

   Most people watch with the sound off, in public, on a small bundle. A free editor's auto-caption feature plus one manual correction pass is enough. Check the local language and the brand names by hand — auto-captions mangle both. Burn the captions in rather than relying on a platform's caption tool.

4. **Do not use cloud rendering**

   It uploads your footage, processes it on a server and downloads the result. At 98 Kb/s that can consume more data than the finished video. Keep every edit on the device.

5. **Export once, at the size you need**

   720p vertical for video, around 1080 pixels on the long edge for photographs.

THE TWO-MINUTE RULE

If an edit takes longer than two minutes for a single post, you are over-editing. Small businesses are not paying for transitions, animated text or sound effects. They are paying for the post to exist, look clean and say something true.

FILE TYPE	STRAIGHT FROM THE PHONE	COMPRESS TO
Product photograph	3–8 MB	200–400 KB, long edge ~1080 px
Carousel (3 images)	10–20 MB	Under 1 MB total
15-second vertical video	30–80 MB at 1080p	5–12 MB at 720p
30-second behind-the-scenes	80–150 MB	10–25 MB at 720p
Report or strategy PDF	1–4 MB	Under 500 KB, or share a link

Working targets, not platform requirements. Platforms re-encode what you upload, so a smaller file usually looks the same and arrives sooner. Keep the original in a `/master/` folder and compress a copy into `/post/`. Compress video last — repeated re-encoding degrades it visibly.

5.5 Posting around the slow hours

Published local reporting on freelancer connectivity records speeds falling as low as **98 Kb/s**, worst between **16:00 and 24:00**. That one fact should shape your working day.

Afternoon and evening — no data needed

- Shooting photographs and video.
- Editing.
- Writing captions in a plain notes file.
- Planning tomorrow's posts and checking the calendar.
- Reading client messages, and answering urgent ones by phone call.

Early morning — everything that uploads

- Uploading images and video.
- Scheduling the day's posts in Meta Business Suite.
- Downloading anything large you need for the week.
- Backing up the batch to a cloud folder.
- Sending reports and documents with attachments.

THE SCHEDULING TRICK THAT SAVES YOUR MONTH

Instead of publishing live every day, do one upload session a week and **schedule the whole week** in Meta Business Suite — Facebook and Instagram both support free scheduling. That turns five risky daily uploads into one. Only do this with the client's agreement.

Keep the time of day realistic. For most small local businesses that means **early morning, the lunch break and the evening**. Ask the client what time of day their customers come in, and use that as your first guess.

5.6 When the internet is down

your country has a documented history of disruptions: a nationwide block of Facebook, Telegram, TikTok and YouTube from February to July 2023, a regional shutdown in Amhara from July 2023 to mid-July 2024, localised Oromia shutdowns through 2024, and reported slowing and YouTube restrictions in several cities in June 2025. Freedom House scored your country 30 out of 100 and rated it "Not Free" for internet freedom in 2025. You cannot control that. You can be the freelancer who keeps working through it.

— **Work offline by default.** Do all shooting, editing and caption writing offline. An outage then costs you an upload slot, not a working day.

— **Keep a text-only post ready** for every client — five written posts, no image, small enough to publish on almost any connection.

— **Post later, not worse.** Publish the text post today, queue the image for the morning, and tell the client one honest line about what happened. Clients forgive delays far more readily than silence.

— **Use the phone for anything urgent.** A two-minute call carries more than twenty texts over three hours of a bad connection.

— **Never blame the platform without checking.** A failed upload is usually a slow connection or an oversized file.

> **DO NOT ADVISE A CLIENT TO USE A VPN**
>
> Do not suggest a VPN to a client to get around a block, and do not offer it as a service. What you can say honestly is: "The connection is restricted today. I have a text post ready and I will publish the images when it clears."

5.7 The honest answer about laptops

EXPLAIN A laptop is **not required**. It is genuinely better for exactly one task: heavy video editing. Everything else — auditing, captions, simple design, scheduling, messaging, reporting — is fine on a phone or actually faster on one, because the client lives on a phone too.

SHOW **Example — fictional.** A freelancer in a regional city runs three clients entirely from an Android phone: a café, a salon and a learning centre. Her only laptop task is a two-minute promotional video each quarter, assembled at an internet cafe in one hour and priced inside the package.

DO Run the workflow on your phone for one full month before buying anything. If one specific task keeps failing, name it, then find the cheapest way to solve just that task.

CHECK You can publish a week of content without touching a computer. If you cannot, find which step blocks you and fix that step.

TASK	PHONE	LAPTOP	VERDICT
Auditing a page	Better — you see what customers see	You see the desktop layout	PHONE
Shooting photos and video	Only option	Not applicable	PHONE
Simple post design	Fine	Easier for precise alignment	EITHER

TASK	PHONE	LAPTOP	VERDICT
Writing captions	Fine, and you can do it anywhere	Faster typing	EITHER

TASK	PHONE	LAPTOP	VERDICT
Scheduling a week of posts	Works in Meta Business Suite	Smoother for bulk scheduling	EITHER

TASK	PHONE	LAPTOP	VERDICT
Editing a 15-second clip	Fine	Not needed	PHONE
Editing a 2-minute video with music and captions	Slow, fiddly, the app may crash	Clearly better	LAPTOP
Monthly report	Fine	Fine	EITHER
Google Business Profile setup	Works, tighter interface	Slightly easier	EITHER

IF YOU DO BUY SOMETHING, BUY IN THIS ORDER

1. **Storage** — running out mid-shoot costs a client's whole month.
2. **A power bank** — batch days kill a battery and a dead phone ends your shoot.
3. **A cheap phone tripod or holder** — it removes shake better than any technique.
4. **A data reserve** — a freelancer's monthly data cost at high usage was reported at up to $19 so budget for it before equipment.
5. **A laptop** — last, only for video editing, and only once you are paid for video.

06

SECTION SIX

Captions, Graphics and Short Video That Get Engagement

Caption structure with ten worked examples for small local businesses, the graphic design rules that make a beginner look professional, three short-video formats with scripts, hooks that work locally, and the honest truth about platform monetization for creators in countries like yours.

01 Caption structure: hook, value, call to action

02 Ten worked captions

03 Graphic design rules for a free tool

04 Three short-video formats with scripts

05 Hooks that work locally

06 The honest truth about monetization

A caption is not a description of a photograph. It is the reason somebody stops, the reason they believe you, and the reason they act.

6.1 Caption structure: hook, value, call to action

EXPLAIN **Hook** — the first line, the only one most people read. It must give a reason to keep going: a price, a question, a specific detail. **Value** — one or two lines of real information: what it is, what it costs, when, where. **Call to action** — one instruction, and only one.

SHOW **Weak:** "Our delicious breakfast platter is available. Come and enjoy!" **Strong:** "Breakfast for two, $480, until 11am. Eggs, ful, chechebsa and two macchiatos. We open at 6:30 and we are two minutes from the main road. Message us to reserve a table." Same photograph, ten times the information.

DO Rewrite your last five posts' captions using the three parts. Keep the strongest before-and-after pair in your sample portfolio — showing a client their own weak caption next to a better one is the most persuasive thing you can do.

CHECK Read it out loud in one breath. If it takes more than one breath, it is too long. If the first line could be posted by any business in the city, rewrite it.

THREE RULES THAT FIX MOST BAD CAPTIONS

— **Put a number in the first line.** A price, a time, a quantity, a distance.

— **Never write "we are pleased to announce".** Nobody reads past it. Write the announcement itself.

— **End with one instruction** a person can do with their thumb: "Message us the size you need."

6.2 Ten worked captions

All ten are written for **fictional example businesses**. Use them as structures, not text to copy. the local language lines are short on purpose — never write the local language line you cannot read aloud correctly yourself.

1 — RESTAURANT, FASTING SEASON

Fasting platter for four, $620, every day until 21:00. Shiro, misir wot, gomen, azifa, salad and injera, all cooked in a separate fasting kitchen. We serve from 11:00 and we do not run out after 19:00. Message us the time you are coming and we will keep a table.

If most customers speak the local language, lead with a short the local language line and follow with the details. Keep numbers and times in figures either way.

2 — CAFÉ, QUIET HOURS

$0.25 for a macchiato, and a socket to charge your phone. We are quiet between 14:00 and 17:00, the Wi-Fi is on, and four tables along the wall have sockets. Coffee is roasted here every morning. Come in and ask for the corner table — it has the best light.

3 — BEAUTY SALON, BOOKING SYSTEM

We take three bridal bookings a week. Two slots are left this month. The package includes hair, makeup, nails and a trial two weeks before the wedding — the trial is inside the price, not added later. Send us the wedding date and we will tell you if the slot is open.

4 — BARBERSHOP, QUEUE MANAGEMENT

Cut and beard, $1.50, and no waiting if you message first. We open at 8:00 and we are busiest between 18:00 and 20:00. Send your name now and we will reply with a time to come.

5 — CLOTHING STORE, SIZE QUESTIONS

Three sizes left in the green kemis: S, M and L. $15. Cotton, hand-finished at the neckline, two days for a custom size, and delivery inside the city for $0.60. Message us your size and we will hold it for 24 hours.

6 — PHARMACY, HOURS AND DELIVERY

Open from 7:00 every morning, including Sunday. We stock baby formula, blood pressure monitors and glucose test strips. Delivery inside the area on orders over $3. Send us the item name and we will confirm whether it is in stock before you come.

Health caution: never write symptoms, diagnoses or treatment claims. Availability, hours and delivery only.

7 — TUTOR OR LEARNING CENTRE, ENROLMENT

Grade 12 maths, three students per teacher, next group starts on the 5th. Four sessions a week, two hours each, with a past-paper test every second Saturday. Fees are paid monthly and the timetable is fixed. Call us with the subject and grade and we will tell you if a seat is open.

8 — PHOTOGRAPHER, GRADUATION SEASON

Graduation shoots: $11 for two hours, two locations, 40 edited photographs. We shoot at your campus and one more place you choose, and edited files arrive within five days through a link you can download on your phone. Send us your graduation date and we will confirm whether it is free.

9 — JUICE HOUSE, DELIVERY

Two litres of fresh juice, $320, delivered to your office. Avocado, mango, papaya or mixed. We press it after you order, not before, so tell us a time and we will bring it then. Send your address and the time you want it and we will confirm in a minute.

10 — PROOF POST, ANY BUSINESS

This is the fourth order this customer has placed this month. She asked us to keep it simple: same order, same address, same time every Friday. That is now a standing order, delivered before 9:00. If you want the same order every week, message us once and we will set it up.

Proof posts work best with a real, specific detail. Cover the name and phone number before posting a screenshot, and ask permission first.

This says: use short the local language sentences — "It is fresh this morning" or "We deliver to your home". Long the local language paragraphs do not get read. If you are not confident writing the local language, ask the client to check your captions before they go out.

6.3 Graphic design rules for a free tool

01 Contrast first

Dark text on light or light on dark. Never grey text on a photograph. If you cannot read it on your own phone in sunlight, it is unreadable.

02 One idea per image

One price, one product, one offer. Add a second message and neither is read. Two things to say means two posts.

03 Brand colours, chosen once

Pick two colours from the client's signboard and use only those plus white and near-black for the whole month.

04 Text big enough to read on a phone

If the smallest text is smaller than the smallest text in a normal Facebook post, it is too small. Cut words and double the size.

05 Avoid stock-photo clichés

No foreign-looking models, no generic handshakes. A real photograph of the real shop always beats a stock image that obviously is not theirs.

06 Keep a margin

Leave empty space on all four sides. Platforms crop differently in the feed, in Stories and in search.

THE TWO GRAPHIC MISTAKES THAT COST CLIENTS MONEY

Spelling in the price. A price card with a wrong number is worse than no price card. Read every number out loud twice and have the client confirm it in writing before you publish.

the local language pasted into a font that does not support it. Letters break and the shop loses face in front of its own customers. Check that your tool has a proper a script-appropriate font, never stretch the local language to fit a space, and get a fluent reader to check before publishing.

6.4 Three short-video formats with scripts

Film vertical, keep the phone steady, use real sound where you can, and burn in captions. Each of these can be shot in under ten minutes once you have done it twice.

FORMAT 1 **The 15-second product demo.** 0–3s the finished product, close, the best-looking moment. 3–10s the making — pouring, plating, folding, cutting. 10–15s the finished product again with the price on screen. **Caption:** the price, the hours, one instruction. **Why it works:** it answers "what is it and how much" in fifteen seconds.

FORMAT 2 **The 30-second behind-the-scenes.** 0–5s the empty room or closed shutter in early light. 5–15s preparation — dough, stock arriving, setting tables. 15–25s the owner or a staff member saying one sentence to camera about why they do it this way. 25–30s the doors opening. **Caption:** the opening time and one question, such as "what time do you usually come?" Questions produce comments, and comments extend reach.

FORMAT 3 **The 20-second customer reaction.** 0–3s the product arriving. 3–12s the first reaction — a smile, a first bite, a try-on. 12–20s one short sentence from the customer, or a text overlay with their words. **Caption:** what they ordered, the price, an instruction to come and try it. If they would rather not be on camera, film hands or the product instead.

CHECK Watch it once with the sound off. If you cannot tell what it is selling and what it costs, it is not finished. The first three seconds must show the most interesting thing, not an introduction.

6.5 Hooks that work locally

HOOK	EXAMPLE	WHY IT WORKS
Price	"Breakfast for two, $480."	Price is the first thing customers scan for
Hours	"Open at 6:30, including Sunday."	Answers "can I come now?", what most local searches really ask
Location	"Two minutes from the main road, behind the bank."	Local customers decide by distance and a landmark they know
Limited	"Three sizes left: S, M and L."	True scarcity creates urgency; invented scarcity destroys trust when checked
Process	"We roast every morning at 6."	Shows effort, which customers read as quality
Proof	"Fourth order from the same customer this month."	Other people's behaviour is the strongest evidence a small business has
Question	"Which one would you take home?"	Questions produce comments, and comments extend reach
Correction	"You do not need to call to check the price."	Names a small annoyance the customer recognises, then removes it

HOOKS YOU MUST NEVER WRITE

— **Invented urgency.** "Only two left" when there are forty.

— **Fake claims about health, income or results.** Never that a product cures something, a course guarantees a job, or a service will double sales.

— **Clickbait that misleads.** "You will not believe what happened" followed by nothing costs a follower every time.

— **Anything mocking a competitor, a nationality, a religion, an ethnicity or a gender.** It can end a business relationship in a day.

Consistency beats production value. Posting three clean, honest posts a week for twelve months does more for a small business than one beautifully produced video that took three weeks and was never followed up. Customers forget a business they have not seen, platforms show more content from accounts that post regularly, and a client who sees a post every few days believes the work is happening. When you must choose between better and sooner, choose sooner and simpler.

6.6 The honest truth about monetization

PLATFORM MONETIZATION PROGRAMMES DO NOT PAY CREATORS IN COUNTRIES LIKE YOURS

— **YouTube's Partner Program does not include your country** on its availability list. Some creators in countries like yours register accounts in other countries to get around this, which is a compliance risk this course does not recommend.

— **TikTok Creator Rewards is limited to roughly 14 countries, with none in Africa.**

— **Meta's in-stream ads and Ads on Reels rolled out to Kenya, Nigeria and Ghana — not your country.**

— **AdSense** appears in Google's official payment-method table for your country, but the availability page could not be read directly when this course was researched. **Verify it in your own account before you rely on it.**

The published CPM figure for your country on YouTube was around **$1.01**, which tells you what ad revenue would be worth even if you were eligible.

WHAT YOU ARE ACTUALLY SELLING

Your client is buying customers, not ad revenue. A café that gets six more tables a week from a page you run does not care about a creator fund. The legitimate money in this market is **services, digital products, sponsorships, lead generation, consulting and community** — not ad-share.

When a client asks whether their videos will earn platform money, the honest answer is: not where you live today. One exception worth knowing: **Telegram Stars is globally available for digital goods through bots**, with no country gate. Section 07 covers it, along with the caution about withdrawing Stars.

This says: when a client asks whether the page will make money, explain that platform advertising revenue is not available where you live — what you sell is customers. Say it plainly and without apologising.

07

SECTION SEVEN

Telegram, the Underrated Channel

Why Telegram matters more than its size suggests, how a business uses a channel and a group together, how to set up a Telegram Business presence, a simple order flow paid through a wallet, the etiquette rules, and the caution about Telegram Stars.

01 Why Telegram matters here

02 Channel plus group

03 Setting up a Telegram Business presence

04 A simple order flow with wallet payment

05 Etiquette rules

06 Telegram Stars and the caution

Most beginners put all their effort into Instagram and Facebook and ignore the channel their customers actually use to talk to businesses.

7.1 Why Telegram matters here

EXPLAIN Telegram does three things in this market that the other platforms do not do as well. It is **fast on a weak connection**. It handles **files and links** without the compression and cropping other platforms apply. And it is **where conversations already happen** — orders, price confirmations, delivery addresses, group buying, community updates.

SHOW **Example — fictional.** Lakeview Style House runs a Telegram channel for new stock and a group for customers. New arrivals go to the channel with a price and a size range. Customers ask questions in the group, where other customers see the answers. Orders come by private message, and a wallet transfer confirms the sale. The Facebook page mostly points people at the Telegram channel.

DO Set up both for one client: a channel only the business posts in, and a group where customers talk. Link them from the Facebook page and Instagram bio, and put the link in every caption for two weeks.

CHECK The channel has a clear name, a description saying what it sells and where, a pinned post with prices and hours, and a working link from the other platforms. If a customer cannot understand the business from the pinned post alone, it is not finished.

WHY THIS IS A SELLING POINT

When you tell an owner "I will also run your Telegram channel and group", they look at you differently from the tenth person who promised them Instagram growth. Telegram is the channel they already use daily, and almost nobody is offering to manage it. It is also where an order can actually be completed.

7.2 Channel plus group

	CHANNEL	GROUP
Who posts	Only the business, and you as an admin	Anyone in the group
What it is for	Announcements: new stock, prices, hours, offers, holiday dates	Conversation: questions, sizes, availability, customer photos, feedback
How often	Three to five times a week	You do not post; you answer, aiming for a few hours
What it replaces	A noticeboard and a price list	A shop counter conversation
Risk	Being ignored, because channels are easy to mute	Spam, arguments and complaints visible to everyone
How they link	The channel is the noticeboard; the group is the counter. Pin a message in the group linking to the channel, and mention the group in every channel post that invites questions	

GROUP MODERATION RULES — SET THESE ON DAY ONE

— **Turn on anti-spam settings** so new members cannot flood the group with links.

— **Pin three lines of rules:** no advertising other businesses, no politics, no forwarded chain messages.

— **Remove spam immediately and silently.** Arguing with a spammer in public is more damaging than the spam.

— **Never delete a genuine complaint.** Answer it publicly and briefly, then move the details to a private message.

— **Decide who is admin** — usually the owner plus you. Never give admin rights to somebody you do not know well.

7.3 Setting up a Telegram Business presence

Telegram changes its features frequently, so **check what is currently available in your own app before you promise any of it to a client.**

1. **Create or clean up the account**

   Use the business's own phone number where possible. Set a clear profile photo — the logo or the shopfront — and the display name exactly as customers say it, including the area.

2. **Turn on the business features**

   In Telegram settings, look for the Business section and set **opening hours**, a **location**, a **greeting message** for new contacts and an **away message** for when the shop is closed. These four settings do most of the work of a receptionist, for nothing.

3. **Create the channel and the group**

   Name the channel after the business. Describe what is sold, the hours and the location. Create the group as a linked discussion group if the app offers it. Pin one post with prices, hours and how to order.

4. **Add a username**

   A username gives a short link like `t.me/yourbusiness` that fits in a caption and is easy to type. Keep it short, spelled simply, and close to the business name.

5. **Get proper access, not a password**

   Never take over the owner's personal Telegram account. Ask to be added as an **admin of the channel and the group**. If they will not give you the shop's own number, run it from your own account only with their written agreement.

6. **Turn on two-step verification**

   Do this before anything else. A takeover of the channel is a takeover of the customer list. **Nobody legitimate ever asks for your one-time code.**

7.4 A simple order flow with wallet payment

THE ORDER FLOW — AN EXAMPLE, ADAPT TO THE CLIENT

```
1. Customer sees the item in the channel
```

```
2. Customer messages: item, size, name, area

3. Business confirms price and delivery, in one message

4. Customer pays by wallet transfer; sends the screenshot
5. Business confirms, delivers, asks for a photo
```

Two messages from the business, maximum: one to confirm, one to close. Every extra message loses a customer.

COPY-READY: THE PINNED ORDER MESSAGE

How to order. 1. Send us a message with the item, the size or quantity, your name and your area. 2. We reply with the total price and delivery time, usually within an hour during opening hours. 3. Pay by wallet transfer to [wallet number] and send us the screenshot. 4. We confirm and deliver. Delivery inside [area] is [example: $0.60], free over [example: $6].

Opening hours: [hours]. Location: [landmark]. **We only accept payment to the number above.** If anyone messages you asking for payment to a different number, it is not us — call us first.

That last line matters more than it looks. The your central bank or financial regulator has warned publicly that fraudsters impersonate people on WhatsApp, Telegram, Facebook, email and SMS, and through fake phone calls, to request urgent transfers. One line naming the only legitimate payment number protects the client's customers and protects you.

WHAT YOU CAN AND CANNOT OFFER AS A PAYMENT METHOD

- **Local customers pay the business directly** by wallet or bank transfer, within your regulator limits in Section 09.
- **Never hold client money in your own wallet** — not deposits, not advertising budgets, not delivery fees. If you hold it, you own the dispute.
- **Never fund a client's advertising from your own pocket** on a promise of reimbursement.
- **Do not offer crypto, and do not accept it.** Virtual-asset activity is prohibited where you live unless expressly authorised.

7.5 Etiquette rules

DO	DO NOT
Post three to five times a week, at consistent times	Post nine times in one day and nothing for two weeks
Put the price and the size in the post	Write "DM for price" on every single post
Answer questions in the group so everyone sees the answer	Answer the same question privately fifteen times
Ask before adding anyone to the group	Add your whole contact list to a business group
Keep forwarded content out of the channel	Forward chain messages, politics or another shop's adverts

DO	DO NOT
Use the owner's voice, with their agreement	Pretend to be the owner in a private message

DO	DO NOT
Say when the shop is closed and when it reopens	Leave customers guessing during a holiday closure

DO	DO NOT
Answer complaints quickly and briefly, then move to private	Argue with a customer in the group
Keep the channel about the business	Mix in your own services or personal posts

This says: "Join our channel to see new stock and prices. Send us a message to place an order." Use it as the standard line in every Facebook and Instagram caption for two weeks after you set up the channel.

7.6 Telegram Stars and the caution that comes with them

EXPLAIN **Telegram Stars** is Telegram's in-app currency for digital goods and services, sold through bots. It is **globally available with no country gate**, which makes it the most usable in-country digital-goods rail described in the research behind this course.

SHOW **Example — fictional.** A fictional learning centre sells recorded maths lessons through a Telegram bot. Students pay in Stars, the lessons unlock, and the centre never handles a card. The product is digital, delivered inside Telegram, and the transaction stays small.

DO If a client wants to try Stars for a small digital product, treat it as a test, keep amounts small, and keep a manual record of every sale. Do not move a business's core income onto it.

CHECK Before you set anything up you can answer three questions: what exactly is being sold, how the sale is recorded, and how the money eventually reaches the business's wallet legally.

THE STARS CAUTION — READ THIS BEFORE YOU BUILD ON IT

Stars are a payment rail, not a business model, and getting the money out is the problem.

Withdrawing Stars is done by converting them to a cryptocurrency token. **Virtual-asset activity, including crypto, is prohibited where you live unless expressly authorised**, following a your central bank or financial regulator notice in July 2026 that drew a red line on virtual assets and cautioned the public against unregulated digital transactions.

So the honest position is this: Stars are usable for selling small digital goods inside Telegram through bots, but the withdrawal route runs through crypto, which you are not permitted to use. **Do not present Stars as a payment solution without saying that clearly**, and do not build a business's monthly income on a rail whose exit you cannot legally use.

HOW TO TALK ABOUT THIS WITH A CLIENT

Say it plainly: "Telegram Stars can take payments for digital things like lessons or files. Getting that money out runs through crypto, and crypto is not permitted where you live, so I would not build your main income on it. For your shop we will take payment by wallet transfer to your own number, and I will never ask your customers to pay anybody else."

That answer is not exciting. It is correct, it protects the client, and it is the kind of thing that makes an owner trust you with their page for a year.

08

SECTION EIGHT

Reporting and Retention

The monthly one-page report, what to include and what to leave out, how to present it in a ten-minute call or a two-paragraph message, the three questions that keep a client another month, and copy-ready monthly and quarterly messages.

01 Why the report is the product

02 The one-page report, section by section

03 What not to include

04 Ten-minute call or two-paragraph message

05 The three retention questions

06 Copy-ready monthly and quarterly messages

A client does not experience your work. They experience the absence of worry. The report is how you make that visible.

8.1 Why the report is the product

EXPLAIN A month of posting is invisible to the client. None of it is in the owner's head on the 30th. **The report is the part of your service the client can actually see.** Without it you are an expense they cannot evaluate, and unmeasurable expenses get cancelled first.

SHOW **Example — fictional.** Two freelancers, same café, same month of work. One sends nothing and gets "let us pause for a while" in month three. The other sends one page on the 28th, and the owner says "wait, fourteen price questions answered — that is more than I thought".

DO Build the template today, before you have a client, and fill it in for a fictional business as practice. Then your first real month costs twenty minutes, not three hours.

CHECK The owner can read it on a phone in two minutes and name one thing you did that they did not know about.

THE RULE THAT MAKES REPORTING HONEST

Report **what you did**, not what you caused. You published twelve posts and answered fourteen questions. You did not cause the increase in sales. An honest report survives a month when sales fall for reasons that have nothing to do with you.

8.2 The one-page report, section by section

#	SECTION	WHAT GOES IN IT
1	**Month and client**	Business name, month, your name, date sent. One line — a document, not a chat message
2	**Posts published**	The number, broken down by pillar. Countable and verifiable
3	**Messages answered**	How many customer questions you answered, and roughly how fast. Usually the number the owner values most
4	**Reach, if available**	What Meta Business Suite or the platform actually shows you
5	**Best post and why**	The one post that did best, with its real numbers, and one sentence on why. The client reads this first
6	**What I will change next month**	Two changes, both inside your control. This is what converts a report into a renewal

ON REACH NUMBERS — BE CAREFUL AND BE HONEST

Free tools do not show everything. If a number is not shown to you, **write "not available in the free tools"**. Do not estimate and never present a figure you did not read off a screen. One invented number destroys the credibility of every honest number in the report.

New followers is a weaker number than people expect. A page that gained eight followers and answered fourteen price questions had a better month than one that gained sixty followers and answered none.

8.3 What not to include, and what to put in instead

Leave these out

— Your hours worked. The client is buying output, not effort.

— Screenshots with no explanation. Five images and no sentence is a puzzle.

— Vanity numbers with no context — impressions, reach, likes.

— Claims about sales. Unless the client tells you a customer came from the page, you do not know.

— Anything about another client, even anonymised.

— Apologies dressed up as excuses. One line: what happened, what you did, what changes.

— Jargon. "Engagement rate" means nothing to most shop owners. Say "how many people saw it".

— Anything longer than one page.

Put these in instead

— The most memorable thing that happened: the biggest order that came through a message, a compliment a customer left.

— One number the owner did not know: how many people asked for the price and got an answer this month.

— One small win down to your routine: the price list now visible in the bio, the hours now correct everywhere.

— One forward-looking sentence: "Next month the fasting season starts, so I will prepare those posts two weeks early."

8.4 Ten-minute call or two-paragraph message

OPTION A **The ten-minute call.** Send the report first, then call. "Did the page arrive?" — the three numbers — what you are changing next month — one question about the business — confirm next month and stop talking at nine minutes.

OPTION B **The two-paragraph message.** For owners who never pick up the phone during working hours, which is most of them. What was done, and what changes next. No attachments, or one link. It fits on one screen, and a report that needs a file opened is read by roughly half of clients.

DO Send the report on the **same date every month**. A client who knows it comes on the 28th notices immediately when it does not.

CHECK After you send it, the client replies with something other than "OK" or a thumbs-up. If they only ever acknowledge, your report gives them nothing to react to.

8.5 The three questions that keep a client another month

01 "What sold best this month?"

It tells you what to post more of, and makes them think about their own business during your call. **Do this:** put the winning product in next month's calendar twice.

02 "What is coming up that I should plan for?"

New stock, a renovation, a holiday, a price change. Each is content, and knowing two weeks early is the difference between a campaign and an embarrassed silence. **Do this:** write the date into the calendar before you end the call.

03 "Is there anything you want me to stop doing?"

The question nobody asks, and the one that saves contracts. Owners quietly dislike something and let it build until they cancel. **Do this:** change it that week and tell them you changed it.

THE MONTH-THREE PROBLEM

Month one the client watches everything you post. Month three they stop looking — and if they stop looking, they cannot see the value, and the payment feels like a subscription to nothing. **The three questions are how you keep the client looking.** A client who sees their own suggestion implemented in ten days is very hard to lose.

8.6 Copy-ready monthly and quarterly messages

MONTHLY REPORT MESSAGE — WHATSAPP, TELEGRAM OR SMS

Selam [owner's name]. [Month] report for [business name].

Published: [number] posts — [number] product, [number] proof, [number] people, [number] place, [number] offer. **Answered:** [number] customer questions, usually within [number] hours. **Best post:** the [describe] from [date] — reached [number, or "the free tools do not show this"] people and got [number] comments, mostly asking about [what they asked].

Two changes for next month: I will [change one], and [change two].

Three quick questions: what sold best this month, what is coming up that I should plan for, and is there anything you want me to stop doing?

Next report: [date].

QUARTERLY REVIEW MESSAGE — EVERY THREE MONTHS

Selam [owner's name]. Three-month review for [business name].

Over three months: [number] posts published, [number] questions answered, and the page has posted every week since [month]. Before we started, the last post was [date].

What has worked: [the pillar or format that performed best, with one example]. **What has not:** [one honest thing that did not work] — I will drop it and put the time into [replacement].

Coming next: [season or event] in [month], so I will prepare those posts two weeks early.

I would also like to talk about the package for the next three months, since the work has grown. Can we take ten minutes this week?

A CLOSING LINE THAT WORKS

End every report with: **"If you want to use any of this yourself, you are welcome to — but if you would rather I keep handling it, I am here next month."** It says you are not desperate, it gives the client control, and it reminds them the alternative is doing it themselves. Clients who feel free to leave stay longer than clients who feel locked in.

09

SECTION NINE

Packages and Pricing in Dollars

A three-tier monthly ladder with example prices, three add-on services, how to price from your own hours rather than from what a competitor charges, the exact words for presenting a price and for raising it after three months, and how you get paid legally where you live.

01 The four questions that settle it in twenty minutes

02 Local clients versus international clients

03 The legitimate routes, in order

04 What never to do

05 Tax and registration, honestly

Every price in this section is an example. There is no published local rate card for social media management that this course could verify, so anything printed here is a teaching illustration to adjust to your own market, city and experience.

Getting Paid by a Local Business

This is the chapter that decides whether the rest of the book turns into money. It is also the chapter most online advice gets wrong, because most online advice assumes you live in a country with a full set of payment rails. If you do, the short version is at the end of this section. If you do not, the rest of this section is for you.

> **THE ONE RULE THAT PREVENTS ALMOST EVERY PROBLEM**
>
> **Agree the payment route with the client before you agree the price.** Not after the work is done, not in the invoice, not when they ask for your bank details. Before.
>
> A client who cannot pay you the way you need is not a client. They are a conversation. Finding that out on delivery day is the most expensive lesson in this book, and it is entirely avoidable with one question asked early.

How money actually crosses a border

When a client in another country pays you, the money does not travel directly. It moves through a chain, and every link in that chain is a place where it can stop. Knowing the chain tells you which question to ask.

1. **The client pays something**
   A card, a PayPal balance, a bank transfer, a mobile wallet, a local payment method. What they can use depends on *their* country, not yours.

2. **A processor authorises it**
   Stripe, PayPal, Adyen, a regional gateway. This is where most cross-border problems originate, because processors operate country by country.

3. **A platform holds it**
   If you sell through a marketplace or course platform, they hold the money and pay you later, on their schedule, at their minimum.

4. **It is paid out to you**
   A bank deposit in your local currency, a PayPal transfer, or a wallet credit. **This is the link that fails most often**, and it is the one nobody checks before they start.

EXPLAIN Buyer-side and seller-side are independent. What your client can use to pay has nothing to do with what you can receive. A platform can be perfectly good for your buyers and completely useless for paying you.

SHOW *Example — fictional.* A writer in Nairobi sells a $25 template pack. Buyers pay by card without difficulty. The platform's payout page then shows one option: PayPal. The writer's PayPal account can send but cannot receive. Fourteen sales, $350, stuck behind a payout route that was never tested.

DO Before you build anything, open the payout settings of every platform you are considering and write down, in one sentence, exactly how money would reach your bank account.

CHECK Can you name the rail, the currency, the minimum payout and the delay? If any of those four is a guess, you have not finished checking.

The four questions that settle it in twenty minutes

Do this once per platform. It takes about twenty minutes and it prevents weeks of wasted work.

QUESTION	WHERE TO LOOK	WHAT A USABLE ANSWER LOOKS LIKE
1. Does this platform pay out to my country?	The platform's own payout-settings page or help article — never a blog post, never a YouTube video	Your country named on the platform's own list, with the payout currency
2. Through which rail?	The same page	A named method: local bank deposit, PayPal, Payoneer, wallet. "Contact support" is not an answer
3. What is the minimum and the delay?	The payout help article	A number and a schedule, so you can plan cash flow
4. What does it cost in total?	The pricing page *and* the fees help article — they often disagree	Platform fee plus processing fee, added together, expressed as a percentage of a typical sale

TWO RULES THAT WILL SAVE YOU MONEY

Read the payout page, not the signup page. Almost every platform lets you sign up from almost anywhere. That tells you nothing. The gate is payout.

Check whether two platforms share a rail. If two services both pay through the same underlying processor, they are not backups of each other. When that one rail has a problem, both stop at once. Verify the underlying rail, not just the brand on the front.

Local clients versus international clients

These are two different problems and they need two different answers. Do not let one delay the other.

	LOCAL CLIENTS	INTERNATIONAL CLIENTS
What works	Bank transfer, mobile wallet, cash, a local card gateway. Almost always available to an individual with no registered business.	A licensed remittance corridor, a platform that pays out to your country, or an employer's own payroll route.
Speed	Same day, often same hour	Days to weeks, depending on the platform's payout schedule
What can block it	Nothing much, if you have an account in your own name	Country eligibility, missing documents, a rail that does not reach you
Best first move	Start here. Local clients pay for your proof.	Test the payout route with a small real payment before you promise anything

THE TEST PAYMENT

Before you quote a single international client, run one small real transaction end to end: sell something cheap — a $5 template, a $10 review, a single small job — and take it all the way to money in your account.

This costs you one afternoon and one small fee. It converts every assumption in this chapter into a fact, and it is the single most useful hour in this entire book.

What to say to a client about payment

Clients are not suspicious of payment questions. They are suspicious of vague ones. Say the route plainly, in the first conversation, in writing.

COPY-READY: THE PAYMENT-ROUTING MESSAGE

Before we start, one practical thing so neither of us has a surprise at the end.

I am paid by `[route: bank transfer / a named platform / a licensed transfer service]`. The money arrives in `[currency]`, and I can start work as soon as the first payment shows on my side.

If you would rather use a different method, tell me now and I will check whether it works — I would rather spend five minutes on this today than a week on it later.

For `[amount]` the split is `[50]` % to start and `[50]` % on delivery.

COPY-READY: WHEN A PAYMENT IS LATE

Hello `[name]` — checking in on the `[amount]` for `[work]`, which I sent on `[date]`. It has not shown on my side yet.

Could you confirm the date it was sent and the reference number? If it has not gone out yet, no problem — just let me know when it will, and I will plan around that.

Pricing when the route costs money

Cross-border routes cost the sender or the receiver money. Decide who absorbs it before you quote, and put it in the price rather than discovering it later.

WORKED EXAMPLE — TARGET ARITHMETIC, NOT A FORECAST

```
Your price for the work: $100
Transfer or platform cost, if you absorb it: $5–$15
What actually reaches you: $85–$95
```

Two ways to handle it: quote a price that already includes the cost, or state plainly that transfer fees are the sender's. What you must not do is quote $100 and then argue about $12 after delivery.

NEVER DO THESE THINGS, WHATEVER ANYONE TELLS YOU

— **Never enter a false country, name or address** on a payment platform. It breaches the provider's terms, it usually fails identity verification anyway, and the consequence is a frozen balance and a closed account — with your customers refunded and your earnings gone.

— **Never use a relative's or friend's account abroad** to receive money that is yours. It is the same misrepresentation with extra steps, and it puts their account at risk too.

— **Never use a VPN to open a financial account** in a country you do not live in.

— **Never buy or rent a verified account.** The seller keeps access to it.

— **Never accept payment in a form your country restricts.** Several countries prohibit or restrict virtual-asset transactions; check your own before you accept anything unusual.

The published terms are unambiguous about this. Most platforms require you not to "create an account using a false identity or information, or on behalf of someone other than yourself", and prohibit misrepresenting your "identity, location or credentials". The stated remedy is suspension or termination, and where an underlying processor makes the final call it is often not appealable.

The legitimate routes, in the order worth trying

#	ROUTE	WHO IT SUITS	WHAT TO VERIFY FIRST
1	A platform that publishes your country on its own payout list, paying into a local bank account in local currency	Anyone selling digital products or courses	That the payout page offers *bank deposit*, not "PayPal only", for your country
2	A licensed money-transfer service (Western Union, MoneyGram, Remitly, WorldRemit and similar) for a one-off client payment	Freelancers and service sellers with a single client	That the receiving country and currency appear on the provider's own corridor list
3	An employer's own payroll or contractor route	Remote employees and long-term contractors	That the employer has paid a contractor in your country before — ask them directly
4	Registering as an exporter of services and receiving into a foreign-currency account	Anyone earning regularly from abroad	Your own country's rules. In several countries this unlocks full retention of foreign-currency earnings and an international card — ask a local accountant, do not guess
5	Trading through a properly registered company in the country where the payout account sits	Established sellers doing meaningful volume	Real incorporation, a real bank account there, real accounting, and any home-country approval required. Legitimate, but slow and expensive — not a shortcut

IF YOU ALREADY HAVE FULL PAYMENT RAILS

Then most of this chapter is not your constraint, and your fastest route is whatever your clients already use: Stripe, PayPal, a card gateway. Skim the four verification questions above anyway — the platform fee difference between two similar services is often several percentage points, and on a hundred sales a year that is real money.

Tax and registration, stated honestly

THIS IS NOT TAX ADVICE, AND THE RULES ARE LOCAL

Almost every country requires you to declare income you earn, and most require some form of tax registration once you are trading. What that means in practice — a tax number, a business registration, a turnover-tax threshold, a VAT threshold — differs enormously from country to country, and the thresholds change.

What to do: find your national tax authority's own website, look for the page on registering as a sole trader or self-employed person, and read the current threshold. If your earnings are small, you may be below every threshold. If they are not, register. A local accountant charges very little for one hour of advice, and that hour is worth more than any general guidance in a book written for the whole world.

Keep a simple record from your first sale: date, client, amount, currency, what it was for, and the fee deducted. That one sheet makes tax time trivial and makes you look professional if anyone ever asks.

IF YOU SELL THROUGH A MARKETPLACE, READ THIS

Large platforms are often the *merchant of record*, meaning they handle sales tax and VAT for the buyer and remit it themselves. That does not remove your obligation to declare the income you receive. It changes what you have to collect, not whether you have to report.

Some platforms also require a tax form before they will pay you at all — a W-9 if you are in the United States, a W-8 series form if you are not, or a local equivalent. If a form is required and not submitted, payouts are usually paused. Complete it early rather than after your first sale.

10

SECTION TEN

Prospecting, Outreach and Onboarding

How to find forty named businesses by neighbourhood and category, why the same method works in regional cities, fourteen copy-ready scripts covering walk-ins, DMs, Telegram, calls, follow-ups, objections and onboarding, and a complete Day 1–30 plan.

01 Building a list of forty

02 Prospecting surfaces that work today

03 The same method outside your city

04 Fourteen copy-ready scripts

05 Handling silence and objections

06 The Day 1–30 plan

07 Month two and month three

Everything in the first nine sections is preparation. This is where money starts, and it starts with a list and a message.

10.1 Building a list of forty

Forty named businesses in a spreadsheet, each with a category, an area, a phone number and a page link. Not forty ideas — **forty specific businesses you could walk into tomorrow.** About four hours to build. Use these exact headers:

COPY-READY: THE PROSPECT SHEET COLUMNS

```
Business | Category | Sub-city or area | Phone | Facebook or Instagram link | Last post date | Problem noticed | Contacted? | Follow-up date | Result
```

Example — fictional. A reader searches "café" in the commercial district on Google Maps and opens the first twenty results, writing each into a sheet. Then the same for "beauty salon" in the central district. Forty rows in one afternoon — his entire prospect list for sixty days. If more than five rows have no contact method, you listed businesses you cannot reach.

10.2 Prospecting surfaces that work today

SOURCE	WHAT IT GIVES YOU	HOW TO USE IT
Google Maps	The primary discovery surface for local businesses	Search a category plus an area and work through the results. Your main tool, and free
a local classifieds site `jiji.com.et`	Live dollars-priced classifieds across Addis sub-cities, with Services and Business & Industry sections	A business paying to list itself already spends money on getting customers — warmer than a random shop
an online business directory `businessguide.ezega.com`	Roughly thirty categories with counts — Restaurants & Cafes (257), Professional Services (2,058), Construction (956) — and a 14-city filter	Use the counts to see where the volume is, and the city filter if you are not in Addis
an online business directory `an online business directory.com/directory`	More than 10,000 companies, with a free "Add your Business"	Better for larger businesses than for cafés
your chamber of commerce member lists `ethiopianchamber.com/our-members/`	Around twelve chambers and six associations with phone numbers	Not a prospect list — use it for association outreach, where one conversation reaches dozens of members

The local Yellow Pages is dead as a channel — its Play Store listing was delisted. And do not build a marketplace; research found over half of local e-commerce platforms earn under $10,000 a year.

THE FASTEST LIST OF ALL: WALK YOUR OWN NEIGHBOURHOOD

Google Maps misses businesses. On a walk you see the ones with a signboard and no listing at all, and those are often the least competitive. **Walk one street, note every business with a signboard, and photograph the signboard** so you keep the phone number. One hour in the commercial district, the central district, a regional city's main road or a regional city's lakeside area produces fifteen to twenty businesses no directory has.

10.3 The same method outside your city

Why regional cities are often easier

— **Less competition for your attention.** Far fewer people approach the same businesses about social media.

— **Walk-ins work better.** A smaller city is more relationship-driven.

— **Fewer listings, more neglect.** Most local pages are quiet and the standard is low.

— **You are visible.** One good result in a regional city gets talked about.

What is harder

— **Smaller budgets.** Adjust, but never below your own hourly floor.

— **Fewer directory listings,** so more of your list is built on foot.

— **Thinner payment options in some areas.** Wallet coverage is broad — a mobile wallet alone reported 60.59 m customers — but agent networks are concentrated in urban areas.

— **Connectivity and regional disruptions.** The offline-first workflow in Section 05 matters more here, not less.

— **Tourism seasonality.** In a regional city, a regional city and Lalibela, time outreach to the month before the season starts.

10.4 Fourteen copy-ready scripts

Replace everything inside the highlighted placeholders. **Change the first line for every business** — identical messages read as spam and get deleted. Never approach two competing businesses on the same street in the same week.

SCRIPT 1 — WALK-IN INTRODUCTION

At a quiet hour, standing, phone in hand. Two minutes maximum.

Selam. My name is **[your name]**, I live around **[area]** and I help businesses here with their Facebook and Telegram pages. I am not selling anything right now — I looked at your page this week and noticed three things.

Your last post was **[month]**, and there are **[number]** people in the comments asking the price with no reply. That is **[number]** customers who chose you and heard nothing.

I wrote it on one page. Can I send you the link? It is free, and if you want to fix it yourself, the list is yours.

Then take their number or Telegram, send the link within the hour, and leave. Do not pitch a package on the first visit.

SCRIPT 2 — FACEBOOK OR INSTAGRAM DM

Selam **[business name]**. I saw your post about **[the specific thing they posted]** — the **[product]** looks good.

I noticed your last post was **[date]** and there are **[number]** unanswered questions in the comments. I wrote a one-page note about it, no charge. Want me to send the link?

SCRIPT 3 — TELEGRAM MESSAGE

Selam. My name is **[your name]**. I help businesses in **[area]** run their pages and their Telegram channel.

I looked at **[business name]**: your prices are not visible anywhere, and your Facebook page has not posted since **[month]**. I put the findings on one page.

Two questions: are you the person who handles the page, and would you like me to send it?

SCRIPT 4 — PHONE CALL OPENER

15:00–17:00 for restaurants and cafés, mid-morning for shops.

Selam, good afternoon. My name is **[your name]**. Is now a bad time? *If yes:* No problem — when is better?

If no: Thank you. I help local businesses with their Facebook and Telegram pages, and I looked at **[business name]**'s page this week. The last post was **[date]** and there are unanswered price questions in the comments. I wrote it up on one page, free. What is the best way to send it — Telegram, or should I bring it in?

SCRIPT 5 — THE AUDIT OFFER

Here is what I do, in one sentence: I look at your page the way a customer sees it, and I write down the three things costing you customers, in priority order.

It takes me twenty minutes and costs you nothing. You get a one-page document, and you can act on it yourself or ask me to. Should I do it this week?

SCRIPT 6 — FOLLOW-UP 1 (THREE DAYS LATER)

Selam [name], just checking the note arrived and opened properly. No rush at all. If it is easier, I can send it as a photograph instead of a link.

SCRIPT 7 — FOLLOW-UP 2 (ONE WEEK LATER, WITH SOMETHING NEW)

Selam [name]. One more thing I noticed since I wrote the note: [a new specific finding, for example "three more people asked for the price this week and got no reply"].

I am not going to keep messaging you. If you want the page handled, tell me and I will explain how it works. If not, the note is yours and I wish you a good season.

SCRIPT 8 — FINAL FOLLOW-UP (TWO WEEKS LATER, THEN STOP)

Selam [name]. Last message from me on this. If the timing is wrong, that is completely fine — the page is not going anywhere and neither am I.

If it helps, I will check the page again in two months and send you an updated note. No charge, no obligation. Is that all right with you?

Then put the date in your sheet and do exactly that. This single habit has produced more clients than any clever pitch.

SCRIPT 9 — PRICE PRESENTATION

Here is how I would work with [business name]: [example: twelve] posts a month, [example: two] short videos, all your comments and messages answered, a 30-day calendar you can see any time, and a one-page report each month. [Example: 6,500] USD a month, paid at the start of the month. There is a smaller package at [example: 3,500] if you want to start slowly. Which sounds closer to what you need?

SCRIPT 10 — "THAT IS TOO EXPENSIVE"

I understand. Can I ask what number would work for you? *Whatever they say, do not simply drop the price. Reduce the package instead.*

All right. At [their number] USD I can do [a smaller, specific package: eight posts instead of twelve, one video instead of two]. Same rate per post, smaller scope. Would that work?

And if that is still too much, the honest answer is that a monthly service may not be right for you yet. The audit is yours to use.

SCRIPT 11 — "WE ALREADY HAVE SOMEONE"

That is good to hear — I am not asking you to change anything.

Can I send you the one-page note anyway? If your person is already doing this, you lose nothing and you can pass it to them. If there is something they have missed, you will know.

Then stay in touch every two months with one specific observation. A large share of this business comes from clients whose previous freelancer stopped replying.

SCRIPT 12 — OBJECTION ABOUT RESULTS

That is a fair question, and I will answer it honestly.

I cannot promise you sales or followers. Nobody can, and anyone who does is guessing. What I can promise is specific: [number] posts a month, every comment and message answered, a calendar you can see at any time, and a one-page report every month. Those are things I control, and they are what make a page look alive.

If we do that for two months and you do not think the page looks better, stop and pay nothing for the third month. *Only make that offer if you can afford to honour it.*

SCRIPT 13 — ONBOARDING WELCOME MESSAGE

Selam [name], welcome, and thank you. Here is exactly what happens now.

1. Access. Please add me as an admin to your Facebook Page and Instagram account, and on your Telegram channel if you have one. I will never change your password, and I will never ask you for a one-time code. If anybody ever asks you for a code and says it is me, call me on [your number] first.

2. First visit on [day and time] to shoot a month of photographs and video — about two hours. Please have [the products / the room / the staff] ready.

3. First posts start on [date]. You will see the calendar before anything goes out.

4. What I need from you: new stock, price changes, closures and holidays a week ahead where you can. And if you dislike a post, say so — I would rather change it than have you quietly not like it.

5. Payment: [example: 6,500] USD on the [1st], by a mobile wallet or bank transfer to [number], with a one-line reminder the day before. **6. Report** on the [28th], with a short call.

SCRIPT 14 — THE 30-DAY CHECK-IN

Selam [name]. One month today: [number] posts published, [number] customer questions answered, and the page has posted every week since [date].

Three questions: what sold best this month, what is coming up that I should plan for, and is there anything you want me to stop doing?

Also, if you have a minute: is there another business in [area] you think would find this useful? I would rather be introduced than cold-message somebody.

10.5 Handling silence and objections

The follow-up rhythm

— **Day 0:** send the audit or introduction.

— **Day 3:** follow-up 1 — short, no pressure, offer an easier format.

— **Day 10:** follow-up 2 — one new finding, then a clear close.

— **Day 24:** final follow-up — permission to check back in two months.

— **Day 90:** the check-back you promised. One new observation, no pitch.

— **Then stop.** Four messages is the limit.

What silence usually means

— **They did not see it.** Most likely — messages get buried.

— **They meant to reply later.** Follow-up 2 usually catches these.

— **They are not the decision maker.** Ask: "Are you the person who decides about the page?"

— **Interested but no money this month.** Ask when the good month is, and put it in your sheet.

— **Not interested.** Fine. Your list has thirty-nine more names.

VOLUME, NOT DESPERATION

Send twenty approaches a week. On honest ratios, twenty may produce two or three replies and, over several weeks, one paying client. A non-reply is therefore not a failure — it is part of the cost of the first client. Readers who quit at eight messages have not tested the market; they have tested their own patience.

Two rules keep volume from becoming spam. **Change the first line for every business,** using something specific you actually saw. And never approach two competing businesses on the same street in the same week — small business communities talk to each other.

10.6 The Day 1–30 plan

Ninety minutes a day. Days 1–10 build the skill and the evidence. Days 11–24 are pure outreach volume. Days 25–30 convert, onboard and set up month two. Complete the check before you move on.

DAYS 01–02 Choose your market and build the workspace

OBJECTIVE Know who you are selling to, and have every tool ready first.

TASK Write down three target business types and two neighbourhoods. Create the prospect sheet with the ten headers and Drive folders `/prospects /audits /samples /clients /templates`. Open a free design tool, a free video editor and Meta Business Suite.

EXAMPLE "Cafés and beauty salons in the central district and the commercial district. Both have phone customers, both already post something, both decide fast."

OUTPUT A notes file with your categories and areas; a working sheet; four apps on your phone.

CHECK

- [ ] You can say who finds each type on a phone
- [ ] You can add a sheet row in under ten seconds

DAYS 03–04 Build twenty prospects, then audit three

OBJECTIVE Twenty named businesses you can reach, and the audit learned by doing it.

TASK Google Maps, your first category, your first area: open the first twenty results and fill every column. Then run the full ten-point audit on three with active pages, timing yourself, and write the single worst finding for each.

EXAMPLE Search *café* in the commercial district. Twenty results, twelve with a page, nine that have not posted in three months. Worst finding: "Last post 4 months ago. 11 price questions unanswered. No address in bio."

OUTPUT Twenty rows with at least fifteen contactable, and three completed audits.

CHECK

- [ ] Fewer than five rows with no contact method
- [ ] Each audit took under 20 minutes
- [ ] Every finding is a fact you could show the owner

DAYS 05–06 Make sample work and the audit template

OBJECTIVE Something to show, and a document you can produce in ten minutes forever after.

TASK Make three sample posts for three **fictional** businesses, each labelled "Sample — created by [your name] for demonstration." Then build the six-section audit template and fill it in completely for one of yesterday's businesses, following the worked example in 2.5.

EXAMPLE **Example scenario — fictional.** A price card for "City Fitness Center", a fasting menu graphic, and a carousel for "Lakeview Style House".

OUTPUT Three labelled samples under 400 KB each, and one finished audit tested on your own phone.

CHECK

- [ ] Every sample carries the label
- [ ] No real business presented as your client
- [ ] The audit fits one page with exactly three findings

DAYS 07–08 Strategy page and the 30-day calendar

OBJECTIVE Plan content in a system rather than by inspiration, and prove you can plan a month.

TASK Fill in the one-page strategy template for a fictional business in your first category, naming two seasons with start dates. Then build a 30-day calendar for it using the exact column headers from 4.5 — twelve posts plus two spare rows.

EXAMPLE A fictional fasting-season restaurant: pillar mix weighted to product and offer, two campaigns — the fast start and a religious holiday pre-orders two weeks before.

OUTPUT One strategy page, one sheet calendar with the pillar mix counted.

CHECK

- [ ] All five pillars appear with something under each
- [ ] Twelve planned posts, every row naming a specific asset
- [ ] No pillar takes more than half the month

DAYS 09–10 Shoot thirty assets, then edit and publish three

OBJECTIVE Prove the whole production chain works on your phone, end to end.

TASK One window with good light, one plain surface. Shoot twenty stills and six vertical clips following the shot lists in 4.2 — practice on fruit, a cup, a shoe. Then edit six assets, compress to the targets in 5.4, write twelve captions using hook, value, call to action, and publish three to your own page labelled as samples.

EXAMPLE "Breakfast for two, $480, until 11am" — hook, value, instruction, in three lines.

OUTPUT Twelve captions, six edited assets, three published samples, and a note of how long each upload took.

CHECK

- [ ] No flash used, every clip vertical
- [ ] Every photo under 400 KB, every video under 12 MB
- [ ] You know which hour uploads fastest for you

DAYS 11–12 Write your packages, and finish the list of twenty-five

OBJECTIVE A price you can say without hesitating, and enough prospects that one rejection does not matter.

TASK Work through the five pricing steps in 9.4 and write Starter, Standard and Growth with example prices, three add-ons, and your own hourly floor. Then add five more prospects from a local classifieds site or an online business directory, or from a walk photographing signboards, and flag your first five for outreach.

EXAMPLE Standard at an example $40: twelve posts, two videos, daily replies, calendar, one-page report. Flagged: two cafés with dead pages, one salon with unanswered DMs, one clothing shop with no prices.

OUTPUT One page with three packages and three add-ons; twenty-five sheet rows with five flagged.

CHECK

- [ ] Each package names what is excluded as well as included
- [ ] You can state each price in under five seconds
- [ ] Your lowest package is above your hourly floor

DAYS 13–14 Send the first ten audits

OBJECTIVE Ten real audits delivered to ten real businesses. This is the day the business starts.

TASK Run one audit each, write it on the template, and send it using script 2, 3 or 4. Log the date and channel. On day 14, send follow-up 1 to anyone who has not replied, then audit and send five more.

EXAMPLE "Your last post was 14 March, and eleven people asked the price with no reply. One page, free. Want the link?"

OUTPUT Ten contacted, five follow-ups sent, every row updated with a follow-up date.

CHECK

- [ ] No message longer than five lines
- [ ] Each names something specific you actually saw
- [ ] No price was mentioned

DAY 15 Walk-in day

OBJECTIVE Five face-to-face introductions — the strongest channel in regional cities and often in Addis too.

TASK Choose one street with at least eight businesses. Visit five at a quiet hour using script 1, two minutes each, and take a phone number or Telegram handle before you leave.

EXAMPLE 15:00–17:00 for cafés and restaurants, mid-morning for shops. Never during a rush, never on a Friday afternoon.

OUTPUT Five visits, at least three phone numbers, an audit link sent the same day to each.

CHECK

- [ ] No package pitched on the first visit
- [ ] Inside each business for under five minutes
- [ ] Every one received the link the same day

DAYS 16–19 Volume block: five approaches a day

OBJECTIVE Twenty-five businesses contacted by day 18, and a practised price by day 19.

TASK Each day: audit and send five new approaches and send the scheduled follow-ups. Ninety minutes total — do not redesign anything. On day 19, reply to every message within the hour, then rehearse script 9 out loud five times including the silence after the number.

EXAMPLE Day 16: five salons in the central district. Day 17: five clothing shops. Day 18: five restaurants plus outstanding follow-ups. Day 19: the silence after "$40 a month" should last three full seconds. Count them.

OUTPUT Twenty-five rows contacted, zero unanswered replies, a price you can say without adding a discount.

CHECK

- [ ] Every contacted row has a follow-up date
- [ ] You changed the first line for every single one
- [ ] You said the price without apologising

DAY 20 Build the list to forty

OBJECTIVE The full list, so the pipeline never runs dry.

TASK Add fifteen more — a second area, a second category, or from a local classifieds site and an online business directory. Add the five you found on your walk if they are not in yet.

OUTPUT Forty rows, every one with a contact method, at least two categories represented.

CHECK

- [ ] Forty rows
- [ ] Fewer than five with no contact method

DAYS 21–24 Second volume block, objections and referrals

OBJECTIVE Thirty-five contacted, practised answers for the three objections you will hear, and introductions instead of cold messages.

TASK Five new approaches a day for three days. Rehearse scripts 10, 11 and 12 out loud and handle every objection without dropping your price. On day 24, message every business that replied — including the ones who said no — and ask: "Is there another business in your area you think would find this useful? I would rather be introduced than cold-message somebody."

EXAMPLE "Too expensive" → "Can I ask what number would work for you?" → reduce the package, not the rate. A café owner introduces you to the salon next door; that introduction is worth twenty cold messages.

OUTPUT Thirty-five contacted, at least five referral requests sent, new names in the sheet.

CHECK

- [ ] Every objection answered without a reflex discount
- [ ] Any package offered was one of your three written ones
- [ ] You asked the people who said no as well as the ones who said yes

DAYS 25–26 Prepare sample sets, then present

OBJECTIVE Two finished month-plans you can show in a meeting, and one real presentation.

TASK For your two warmest prospects, build a sample calendar and three sample posts for their own business, labelled "Sample — created by [your name] for demonstration, not commissioned." Then book a specific time, bring the samples and your three packages, use script 9 for the price, and ask for a decision.

EXAMPLE "Here are three posts I made for your page. Here is what a month would look like. Standard is an example $40. Which package sounds closest?"

OUTPUT Two sample sets, six labelled posts, and a yes, a no, or a specific next step with a date. All three are progress.

CHECK

- [ ] Every sample is labelled and uses their own photographs
- [ ] You asked for a decision rather than leaving it open
- [ ] You said the price once and then paused

DAY 27 Onboard, or follow up within 24 hours

OBJECTIVE Either start a client properly, or keep a live conversation alive.

TASK If you got a yes: send script 13, agree the first visit date, request admin access properly, confirm payment at the start of the month. If not: send a same-day message thanking them and asking the one question they did not answer.

EXAMPLE "Thank you for the time today. You mentioned the price was the issue — what number would work, and what would you want included at that number?"

OUTPUT A booked first client visit, or a live conversation with a specific next step.

CHECK

- [ ] Admin access requested properly, never a password
- [ ] The first visit is in both calendars with a time
- [ ] You never asked for a one-time code

DAY 28 Contact the last five, and update every row

OBJECTIVE Forty contacted, and an accurate record of what happened.

TASK Send the last five approaches. Then fill the "Result" column for all forty: replied, no reply, not interested, wrong person, revisit in two months, client.

EXAMPLE Six replied, two had real conversations, one said revisit after the rainy season, thirty-two no reply.

OUTPUT Forty rows contacted, every row with a result and a follow-up date.

CHECK

- [ ] Forty contacted
- [ ] Everyone who said "not now" has a revisit date

DAYS 29–30 Batch, publish and set up month two

OBJECTIVE Deliver something real, find out how long the work takes, and have month two already running.

TASK Run the three-block batch day — twenty photographs in the morning, six clips in the afternoon, thirty captions in the evening — timing each block. Then publish the first three posts in a good upload window, schedule the rest of the week, set up the client's Telegram channel and group, and write the report template with the first month's dates in it.

EXAMPLE "Shoot 2 h 10 m, film 1 h 40 m, captions 2 h 20 m. Total 6 h 10 m." That number, not a hoped-for one, is the real basis of your price.

OUTPUT Posts live by 09:00, next week scheduled, Telegram pinned with prices and hours, next batch day in your calendar.

CHECK

- [ ] Posts are live and the client has seen them
- [ ] Comments and messages answered the same day
- [ ] You know your next batch day and report date

10.7 What month two and month three look like

Month two — deliver and prove

— One batch day, twelve posts published, no missed week.

— Answer every comment and message the same day. This is the month the client watches most closely.

— Send the first monthly report on the agreed date, even if the numbers are small.

— Keep sending five new approaches a week. One client is not yet a business.

— Measure your real hours. Change nothing about the price yet.

Month three — report and raise

— Deliver exactly as agreed, with no quiet weeks.

— Send the price-increase message from 9.6 three weeks before the new month.

— Offer the Google Business Profile add-on if the business has a physical location — the easiest upgrade to sell because it is visibly useful.

— Ask for a referral from every business that replied, whether or not they became a client.

— Aim for two clients and a routine. Two is where the work starts to feel like a system rather than an emergency.

What to be honest with yourself about

- Some readers finish Day 30 with one client, some with none, some with three. The plan controls the work, not the outcome.
- If you reached forty approaches with nothing, the problem is usually the offer or the follow-up rhythm. Re-read 10.5 and try ten more with a sharper first line.
- If you stopped at twelve approaches, that is not a market result. That is an unfinished test.
- More than 80% of federal business licences issued went dormant during 2025. Losing a client is normal here. Losing the habit of prospecting is what ends the business.

TARGET EXAMPLE — NOT A PREDICTION

```
3 clients × $25 = $75 per month
Hours at 10 h per client = 30 hours per month
```

Arithmetic, not a forecast. It does not account for clients who pause, months with no new client, data and transport costs, or the time you spend prospecting.

CLOSING

Common Mistakes and How to Fix Them

Read this twice: once now, and once after your first paid month, when it will read differently.

MISTAKE	WHAT IT COSTS YOU	THE FIX
Approaching kiosks and brand-new shops	Weeks of conversations with people who have no monthly margin	Use the three-signal test in 1.3. Two out of three or move on

MISTAKE	WHAT IT COSTS YOU	THE FIX
Selling "social media management" instead of one fix	The owner nods, understands nothing, never replies	Lead with the finding: "eleven price questions unanswered, no address in your bio"

MISTAKE	WHAT IT COSTS YOU	THE FIX
Sending the audit and the price together	The gift becomes a sales pitch and the free work earns nothing	Send the audit alone, wait for a reply, present the package separately

MISTAKE	WHAT IT COSTS YOU	THE FIX
Auditing a page on a laptop	You miss the cropping, tiny text and missing location pin customers see	Always audit on a phone. Twenty minutes, and more accurate
Promising followers or reach	You own a number you cannot control and will be judged on it in month three	Promise what you control: posts published, messages answered, calendar, report
Posting daily from scratch instead of batching	You spend every evening deciding and quit by month two	One batch day a month: twenty stills, six clips, thirty captions

MISTAKE	WHAT IT COSTS YOU	THE FIX
Uploading in the evening	Uploads stall and fail and you blame the platform	Publish 06:00–09:00, or schedule during the good hours in Meta Business Suite
Exporting at 4K and letting the platform shrink it	More data, slower uploads, no visible gain on a phone screen	Shoot high if you have the space, export at 720p, check the file size first
Ignoring the inbox	The client's customers ask and hear nothing. Fastest way to lose an account	Twenty minutes a day, every day. The inbox is half the service you sell
Posting meat offers during a fasting season	The client looks out of touch with their own customers	Confirm the season and start date, write it on the strategy page, re-confirm every year
Using stock photos of foreign models	Customers recognise instantly that the image is not theirs	Use the client's own photographs. A real shopfront beats a perfect stranger

MISTAKE	WHAT IT COSTS YOU	THE FIX
Not labelling sample work	One discovery of an invented client destroys every real claim	Label every unpaid piece and never remove the label, even if asked
Photographing customers without permission	A complaint, a takedown, damage in a community where everyone talks	Ask first, keep the answer, cover names in screenshots, never film children without a parent's agreement
Holding the client's ad budget in your wallet	You become responsible for money that is not yours	The client funds their own ads from their own account. You charge a management fee only
Paying for a client's ads on a promise	You are out of pocket and the money does not come back	Never. If the client cannot fund the campaign, it does not run
Setting the price during the conversation	You always go lower than you intended	Write three packages before you talk to anyone. Say the number once and pause
Discounting without removing anything	Your price drops permanently and your hours do not	Reduce the package, never the rate. Eight posts instead of twelve

MISTAKE	WHAT IT COSTS YOU	THE FIX
Skipping the monthly report	The client stops seeing the work and cancels in month three	Same date every month. One page: posts, messages answered, best post, what changes next

MISTAKE	WHAT IT COSTS YOU	THE FIX
Reporting sales you cannot prove	One unverifiable claim makes every honest number suspect	Report what you did and let the client connect it to their own sales

MISTAKE	WHAT IT COSTS YOU	THE FIX
Stopping outreach after the first client	That client pauses and your income goes to zero in one month	Five new approaches a week, forever. More than 80% of federal business licences issued went dormant during 2025 — churn is normal here

MISTAKE	WHAT IT COSTS YOU	THE FIX
Taking over the client's personal account	A dispute about access, or a lost customer list if the account is compromised	Ask to be added as an admin of the Page, the Instagram account and the Telegram channel. Never ask for a password
Promising what a platform will pay the creator	You sell a fantasy. YouTube's Partner Program does not include your country, TikTok Creator Rewards has no African country, and Meta's in-stream ads went to Kenya, Nigeria and Ghana — not your country	Sell customers, not ad revenue. Say it plainly and the client will trust everything else you say

CLOSING

FAQ — Honest Answers

How much can I charge?

There is no published local rate card for this work, so this course gives examples, not rates. The ladder in Section 09 runs from an example $22 for Starter to $11,000 for Growth, and **those figures are illustrations to adjust to your market and experience**. Count your real hours, add your data and transport costs, set an hourly figure you would not resent, then adjust up where one customer is worth a lot. Ask five local businesses what they pay somebody today, then decide.

Do I need a laptop?

No. Almost everything here is designed for a phone, and some of it is better on one. The single task where a laptop is clearly better is editing a longer video — around two minutes with music, captions and multiple clips. Without a laptop, keep client video to single-take clips under 30 seconds cut on the phone, and use a friend's laptop or an internet cafe for one hour if a client ever needs more. Price that job so the hour is already paid for.

What if the client has no good photos?

That is normal, and it is one of the reasons they are hiring you. Your batch day exists to create the photographs. Go in with a shot list, use window light and one plain surface, and shoot twenty images in about two hours. If the premises are genuinely too dark, shoot outside the door in daylight.

Never fill the gap with stock photographs of foreign-looking models — customers recognise it immediately and it makes the business look less real, not more.

What if they will not give me the account password?

Good. **You should never ask for a password and you should not want one.** Ask to be added as an admin of the Facebook Page and Instagram account through Meta Business Suite, and as an admin on the Telegram channel. If a client insists on giving you their password, decline politely: "If anything ever happens to your account, I do not want to be the person who had the password."

How many clients can one person handle?

On the example workload here — about ten hours per client per month — three to five clients is a realistic ceiling for one person working part-time alongside study or a job. It is higher if all your clients are in one area and you batch two in the same visit, and lower if a client wants edited video every week. The way most freelancers lose a client is by taking on one too many and letting the quality drop.

What if I cannot show results?

Then do not claim results. Show work instead. "Twelve posts published, every price question answered, the page has posted every week since April" is a result you can prove, and a real improvement on a page that had not posted since March. Most owners understand that you cannot control their sales. What they cannot forgive is a promise you could not keep.

Should I promise followers?

No. Never promise a follower number, a reach number or a viral post. You do not control any of them. You can honestly say you will post consistently, answer every message, and publish on the days that matter for their season. Those are the inputs, and inputs are what a service provider sells.

What if they stop paying?

Stop posting — politely, and in writing. Send one message: "I have not received the payment for [month]. I will pause posting until it comes through, and start again the same day it does." Do not continue for a second month on a promise. Do not delete their posts or their page; that would be damaging and it is not yours. Keep a written record of every payment and agreement from the beginning, because that record makes this conversation short rather than ugly.

Do I need a business licence?

For local clients paying you by wallet or bank transfer as an individual, no. A merchant payment gateway, however, requires a registered business with a trade licence, TIN and Memorandum of Association — and no verified gateway onboards an unlicensed individual. TIN registration is mandatory, and turnover tax is 2% on goods sold locally and 10% on other services, with VAT rules that may apply to you. Confirm your position with your local tax office — before you decide a licence is unnecessary, not after.

How do I get paid?

Local clients:Foreign clients:
What this course will not pretend:

Can I do this outside Addis?

Yes, and often with less competition. a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city, a regional city and a regional city all have cafés, salons, restaurants, hotels, clinics and learning centres with neglected pages. Walk-ins carry more weight in a smaller city and one good result gets talked about.

What is harder: budgets may be smaller, there are fewer directory listings so you build more of your list on foot, and regional connectivity disruptions happen. Adjust your example prices to the local market, but never work below your own hourly floor.

What about platforms being blocked?

It has happened and it may happen again. your country blocked Facebook, Telegram, TikTok and YouTube nationwide from February to July 2023, there was a regional shutdown in Amhara from July 2023 to mid-July 2024, and localised disruptions continued. Freedom House rated your country "Not Free" for internet freedom in 2025. The professional response is a workflow that survives it: shoot, edit and write captions offline, keep a text-only post ready for every client, publish when the connection allows, and give the client one honest line about what happened. Do not advise a client to use a VPN, and never tell a client a platform is blocked before you have confirmed it.

Is this market saturated?

Addis has plenty of people offering social media services, and the bottom of the market competes on being cheapest. That is exactly why this course pushes three things: a specific audit instead of a general pitch, monthly packages instead of single posts, and Telegram plus Google Business Profile — two areas almost nobody is offering to manage. The businesses with neglected pages outnumber the freelancers willing to walk in and talk to them. What is genuinely scarce is not skill. It is somebody who posts every week for a year without being chased.

What if the client wants me to buy followers?

Refuse, and explain in one sentence: "Bought followers do not buy anything, and if anybody checks, your page looks worse, not better." It breaches platform terms, it produces no customers, and a small business community will find out. If the client insists, that is a client you should not take — the same person will later ask you to fake a review or invent a result.

How long before this pays?

Nobody can tell you, and this course will not pretend to. The thirty-day plan gets forty businesses approached and the skill built. Whether a paying client comes in week three, month two or month five depends on your city, your list and your follow-up discipline. What can be said honestly is this: readers who stop at twelve approaches have not tested the market, and the most common reason people give up is not rejection — it is silence, which feels like rejection but usually just means a busy shop owner did not read the message.

CLOSING

How to Spot a Fake Opportunity

Beginners in this field are targeted, because they are eager, polite and often paying for their own training. These are the traps and the rules that protect you.

TRAP	HOW IT WORKS	WHAT TO DO
Fake digital-marketing courses charging a registration fee	A page or person promises to teach you social media marketing and asks for a registration or certificate fee up front, often by wallet transfer. The material never arrives, or it is generic slides copied from the internet	Never pay a registration fee to access training. Legitimate training charges for the teaching, gives a receipt, names a provider you can check, and lets you reach a real person. Ask for the syllabus and the trainer's name first

TRAP	HOW IT WORKS	WHAT TO DO
Agencies that take a deposit and vanish	An "agency" subcontracts work to you and takes a deposit for "onboarding and tools", then stops answering	Never pay a company to give you work — employment does not run in that direction. Ask for a business name you can search, a phone number you can call, and one previous person you can speak to

TRAP	HOW IT WORKS	WHAT TO DO
"Buy followers" and engagement services	Cheap followers, likes and comments sold on Telegram to make a page look successful so clients trust you faster	Refuse. It breaches platform terms, produces no customers, can get a client's account restricted, and any client who checks will find out

TRAP	HOW IT WORKS	WHAT TO DO
Account-rental offers	Somebody offers you money to rent your Facebook, Instagram or Telegram account, or your verified profile, for "advertising purposes"	Never rent, buy or lend an account. A rented account is used for fraud in your name and you carry the consequences
Clients who ask you to fund their ads	"Put the campaign on your card, I will reimburse you at the end of the month."	Never. Not once, not for a small amount, not for a client you like. The client funds their own advertising. This one rule prevents most of the money you could lose in this business
Platform-verification scams	Someone claims they can get a client's page verified, or restore a restricted account, for a fee — and asks for account access or payment to a personal wallet	Verification is not something you can reliably buy from a stranger, and account recovery does not require payment to an individual. You do not sell verification, and neither should anyone they meet on Telegram

THE YOUR CENTRAL BANK OR FINANCIAL REGULATOR'S WARNING

The your regulator has publicly warned that fraudsters impersonate people on **WhatsApp, Telegram, Facebook, email and SMS**, and through fake phone calls, to request urgent transfers. Report suspected fraud to `your regulator's complaint address` or call `6230`.

For your business this means one habit: **treat every urgent payment request as fraudulent until you confirm it by calling the person on a number you already had.** Not the number in the message — the number in your contacts.

THE DOCUMENTED TELEGRAM ACCOUNT-TAKEOVER SCAM

local press has documented scammers who pose as **Telegram security staff**, ask for your password and a one-time code, seize the account, and then message your contacts asking for money in your name. Your account is an attractive target because it holds client conversations, price agreements and files.

Nobody legitimate ever asks for your one-time code. Not Telegram, not a bank, not a wallet, not a "security team", not a client, not an employer, not someone claiming to be from Meta. There is no exception to this rule and there never will be.

Turn on two-step verification today, keep your phone number current, do not click login links sent by strangers, and if you think your account has been taken, **call your clients by phone immediately** — because a message from your account will be believed.

THE CLIENT-IMPERSONATION TRAP

Someone messages a business pretending to be you, offering a cheaper package, and collects a payment. Or someone messages you pretending to be a client, asking you to send the page's login details to "the new manager".

Two habits prevent both. Agree with every client that **payment details are only ever sent from one number**, and put that line in their pinned order post. And **confirm any change of access by phone** — never hand over admin rights on the strength of a message.

THE OVERPAYMENT REFUND SCAM

Someone "accidentally" sends more than the agreed fee, then asks you to send the difference back to a different number or to a third party. The original transfer is later reversed, and the money you sent is gone.

Rule: never refund an overpayment to a third party. Ask the sender to reverse it through their own provider, in writing, and wait. If they become urgent and angry about it, that is the scam, not the inconvenience.

The eight-point legitimacy checklist

Before you accept a client, a collaboration, a training offer or a job, work through all eight. If two or more fail, walk away.

- [ ] They can name their business, and it exists when you search for it
- [ ] They are willing to speak on a phone call or meet in person, not only by text
- [ ] They accept a written scope and expect to pay at the start of the month
- [ ] They never ask for your password, your one-time code, or access to your personal account
- [ ] They do not ask you to fund their advertising, pay a registration fee, or send money to a third party
- [ ] They do not ask you to misrepresent where you are, or to use somebody else's account or identity
- [ ] They do not propose payment in a form this course has told you is prohibited or unverified
- [ ] They do not ask you to buy followers, reviews or verification

No checklist proves that a person is honest. It only removes the obvious risks. Losing one client costs you a month; losing a month of unpaid work, or an account full of client conversations, costs you the business.

Sources & Further Reading

Every platform figure in this book traces to one of the sources below, all checked in September 2026. Platform country lists, payout methods and fees change often — confirm anything you intend to rely on at the source itself.

1. Gumroad — pricing and fee structure — https://gumroad.com/pricing
2. Gumroad — getting paid, bank-payout country list and payout schedule — https://gumroad.com/help/article/13-getting-paid
3. Gumroad — fees in detail — https://gumroad.com/help/article/66-gumroads-fees
4. Gumroad — payout settings, identity documents and tax IDs — https://gumroad.com/help/article/260-your-payout-settings-page
5. Gumroad — account suspension and what causes it — https://gumroad.com/help/article/160-suspension
6. Gumroad — terms of service (identity, location and account rules) — https://gumroad.com/terms
7. Lemon Squeezy — supported countries for sellers — https://docs.lemonsqueezy.com/help/getting-started/supported-countries
8. Lemon Squeezy — W-8 and W-9 tax forms for non-US sellers — https://docs.lemonsqueezy.com/help/tax-forms/w8-w9-forms
9. Lemon Squeezy — pricing — https://www.lemonsqueezy.com/pricing
10. Stripe — cross-border payouts and supported regions — https://docs.stripe.com/connect/cross-border-payouts
11. IRS — About Form W-8BEN — https://www.irs.gov/forms-pubs/about-form-w-8-ben
12. IRS — United States income tax treaties A to Z — https://www.irs.gov/businesses/international-businesses/united-states-income-tax-treaties-a-to-z
13. Whop — payout methods and countries — https://docs.whop.com/manage-your-business/manage-payouts/payout-methods
14. Payhip — how sellers get paid — https://help.payhip.com/article/173-how-do-i-get-paid
15. Ko-fi — how creators get paid — https://help.ko-fi.com/hc/en-us/articles/115003980093-How-do-I-get-paid
16. Fungies — countries you can sell from — https://fungies.io/global-availability/
17. Telegram — Telegram Stars for digital goods — https://telegram.org/blog/telegram-stars
18. Google — Business Profile supported countries — https://support.google.com/business/answer/6270107
19. YouTube — Partner Program availability by country — https://support.google.com/youtube/answer/7101720
20. DataReportal — global digital statistics — https://datareportal.com/reports/digital-2026-global-overview-report
21. World Bank — World Development Indicators — https://databank.worldbank.org/source/world-development-indicators
22. International Labour Organization — ILOSTAT employment data — https://ilostat.ilo.org/
23. Internet Society — Internet shutdown and disruption reporting — https://www.internetsociety.org/
24. FATF — virtual asset and payment-service guidance by jurisdiction — https://www.fatf-gafi.org/

Where research could not verify a fact, this book says so in the text and tells you to check it yourself. Those gaps were left as gaps deliberately.

CLOSING

Final Checklist

Work through this before you approach your first business, and again at the end of your first paid month. Tick honestly — an unticked box is information, not failure.

Before your first approach

- [ ] I have named three target business types and two neighbourhoods or sub-cities
- [ ] I can explain in one sentence why each type has customers who use a phone
- [ ] I have a Google Sheet with the ten prospect columns and at least twenty rows
- [ ] I have run the ten-point audit at least three times, on a phone, in under twenty minutes each
- [ ] I have a one-page audit template with the six sections
- [ ] I have three labelled sample pieces for fictional businesses
- [ ] I have filled in a one-page strategy template for one fictional business
- [ ] I have a 30-day calendar built with the exact column headers
- [ ] I have shot at least twenty stills and six vertical clips on my phone
- [ ] I know how to compress a photo under 400 KB and a video under 12 MB
- [ ] I know which hours upload fastest on my own connection
- [ ] I have three written packages with example prices, and I know what each excludes
- [ ] I have written down my own hourly floor
- [ ] I can say each price out loud in under five seconds without adding a discount
- [ ] I have a written record format for payments: date, amount, method, month covered

Before you send an outreach message

- [ ] The first line names something specific I actually saw on their page
- [ ] The message is five lines or fewer
- [ ] There is no price in the audit message
- [ ] Every finding is a countable fact: a date, a number of comments, a missing field
- [ ] I have not messaged two competing businesses on the same street this week
- [ ] The follow-up date is already in my sheet
- [ ] I have followed up no more than twice before the final message
- [ ] I have sent at least twenty approaches this week

Before you accept a client

- [ ] We agreed in writing what is included: posts, videos, replies, calendar and report

- [ ] We agreed what is not included

- [ ] We agreed the monthly fee and that it is paid at the start of the month

- [ ] I never asked for a password, and I never will
- [ ] I asked to be added as an admin of the Page, the Instagram account and the Telegram channel

- [ ] I told the client that nobody legitimate ever asks for a one-time code, including me
- [ ] The client funds their own advertising from their own account
- [ ] I will not hold client money, advertising budget or delivery fees in my own wallet
- [ ] I have a written scope confirmation by message
- [ ] I have confirmed the client's seasons and the dates they do not want me to post

At the end of your first paid month

- [ ] Every post in the calendar was published, or the client was told why not
- [ ] Every comment and message was answered the same day
- [ ] The one-page report went out on the agreed date
- [ ] The report contains no number I did not read off a screen
- [ ] I asked the three retention questions: what sold best, what is coming, what should I stop
- [ ] I wrote down my real hours for the month
- [ ] I checked whether my price is still above my hourly floor
- [ ] I sent at least twenty new approaches during the month
- [ ] I asked for at least one referral
- [ ] I have a batch day booked for next month

Final Challenge: Approach 20 local Businesses

Not twenty ideas. Not twenty names you recognise. Twenty businesses you actually contacted, with a specific finding about each one and a follow-up date in your sheet.

This is the challenge because everything else in this course is preparation, and preparation does not pay. Twenty approaches is about one week of work at four a day, and it is enough to find out whether this market wants what you are selling.

01 Choose one category and one area. Do not spread across the whole city.

02 List twenty named businesses with a phone number or a page link for each.

03 Run the ten-point audit on each one, from a phone, and write one finding.

04 Write a one-page audit for the ten best, using the six-section template.

05 Send all twenty, changing the first line every single time. Five a day.

06 Walk into five of them in person, at a quiet hour, two minutes each.

07 Follow up on day 3, day 10 and day 24. Then stop.

08 Log every outcome in the sheet, including the silences.

WHAT THIS CHALLENGE DOES AND DOES NOT PROMISE

Approaching twenty businesses does not guarantee you a client. It cannot. Nothing in this course can promise that. Some readers will approach twenty and get one client. Some will get three. Some will get none, and will get one on the twenty-eighth approach three weeks later.

What twenty approaches does guarantee is that you will have tested the market instead of guessing about it. You will know what owners say, what they object to, which finding lands hardest, and whether your price holds up in a real conversation. That knowledge is the actual asset you are building, and it is the one thing a competitor cannot copy from you.

If you reach twenty and nothing has worked, do not conclude that the market is closed. Change one thing and try ten more: the category, the area, the first line, or the follow-up timing. The most common reason beginners fail at this stage is not rejection. It is stopping at twelve.

Your tracking sheet

COPY-READY: CHALLENGE TRACKING COLUMNS

```
Number | Business | Category | Area | Phone or link | Finding noticed | Channel used | Date sent | Follow-up date | Result
```

Number — 1 to 20. **Business** — the real name. **Category** — café, salon, restaurant, shop. **Area** — the district, neighbourhood or street. **Phone or link** — at least one way to reach them. **Finding noticed** — one specific, countable fact you saw on their page. **Channel used** — DM, Telegram, phone call or walk-in. **Date sent** — the day you actually sent it. **Follow-up date** — the next date you will contact them. **Result** — replied, no reply, not interested, wrong person, revisit in two months, or client.

Approaches sent this week .....

Replies received .....

Real conversations held .....

Clients won .....

The one thing I will change next week .....

CLOSING

Next Steps

You now have a service you can sell, a script for every conversation, a calendar system and a price. Where you go next depends on which part of the work you enjoyed most.

05 Canva to Cash

If your favourite part was making things look good — the price cards, the offer graphics, the simple posts — take the visual side further. That course covers design rules, print-ready files, menus and flyers, portfolios, and pricing for design work in dollars.

Take it if clients keep asking you for a poster, a menu or a banner as well as posts. **How it combines:** offer it as an add-on to your Standard package — a client who already trusts you with their page will buy a menu redesign from the same person.

09 The local Online Service Business

If you want to raise the monthly value of each client without working many more hours, this is the one. It covers adding services, structuring your offer, and building the systems that let you handle more clients at a higher fee.

Take it if you have one or two clients and you are wondering how this becomes a real monthly income rather than pocket money. **How it combines:** it turns a three-client freelance habit into a business with a name, a price list and a repeatable process.

08 Audience Building

If you enjoyed running your own page and want an audience of your own — one that brings clients to you instead of you chasing them — this course covers building that audience honestly and slowly.

Take it if you would rather be found than keep prospecting, and you are willing to post consistently for six months before it works. **How it combines:** a small, real local following makes every future outreach message easier, because people already recognise your name.

10 The Full Build

If you want the complete picture — several income streams, the systems behind them, and how they fit together over a year rather than a month — this is the full build.

Take it if you have finished this course, you have at least one paying client, and you are ready to plan further than the next thirty days. **How it combines:** it places social media management inside a wider set of services, so you are not dependent on one type of work or one type of client.

ONE LAST THING, AND IT IS THE ONLY ADVICE THAT MATTERS

You have read a course about a business built entirely out of small, unglamorous actions: opening a page, writing down a date, sending a message, answering a comment, sending a report on the same day every month.

None of it is difficult. All of it is easy to postpone. The readers who get clients are not the ones who understood this course best. They are the ones who sent the twentieth message after nineteen silences.

So close this and send one message today. Not tomorrow, not after the samples are perfect. Today. The business starts the moment a real business owner reads your name.

GLOBAL EDITION · FIRST EDITION · SEPTEMBER 2026

The Social Media Manager Starter Course

How to Start a Social Media Management Business With Almost No Money

LEGAL, DISCLAIMER AND HOW TO READ THIS

Copyright & Disclaimer

The Social Media Manager Starter Course — First Edition · September 2026

Publisher: NexKit your country Editorial Team. This course was written, edited and checked against published sources by the NexKit your country Editorial Team. It is not attributed to any individual author, and no personal credentials, photographs, earnings proof or biographies are presented anywhere in it.

What this course is

A practical, your country-specific operating manual for running the social media of a small local business as a paid monthly service. It covers how to choose which businesses are worth approaching, how to audit a page from a phone in twenty minutes, what to post for an local audience, how to plan thirty days of content in one sitting, how to shoot and edit on a phone with a small data bundle, how to write captions and scripts, how to use Telegram, how to report to a client and keep them, how to price a monthly package in dollars, and exactly what to say when you walk in or send a message.

Every number, fee, platform rule and statistic in this course is traceable to a published source listed in the Sources & Further Reading section at the back, or it is clearly labelled as an example.

What this course is not

It is not a promise of income. It does not guarantee that you will find a client, keep a client, or earn any specific amount. It cannot make a business succeed, and it cannot make a page grow on demand.

It is not legal, tax, accounting, financial or investment advice. It cannot tell you what a platform, a bank, a wallet provider or a government office will decide about your particular case. Those decisions depend on your documents, your record and the rules in force on the day you ask.

FINANCIAL AND LEGAL DISCLAIMER

Nothing in this course is a guarantee of income, clients, results or platform approval. Every money figure is either a published statistic with a source, or an **example to adjust to your own market and experience**. The price examples in dollars are teaching illustrations, not recommended rates and not a forecast of what anyone will pay you.

You are responsible for complying with local law, your tax obligations, the terms of service of every platform you use, and the requirements of any payment provider, wallet or bank you receive money through. This course is educational material only. It is not financial, legal, tax or investment advice, and it does not replace advice from a qualified professional or from the responsible office.

EXAMPLES ARE FICTIONAL

Every business named in this course is invented to teach a method and is labelled **Example scenario — fictional**. Client pages, audit findings, captions, prices, reports and messages are all illustrations. No real, recognisable local company appears here as a customer, a case study or a result.

CURRENCY, DATES AND VERIFICATION

Figures cited in this course are current as of **September 2026** unless a specific date is printed beside the figure. Source URLs for every statistic appear in the Sources & Further Reading section at the back of this course. Where this course could not verify a fact, it says so in the text and tells you to check it yourself before you rely on it.

Platform rules, free-plan limits, payment fees and country availability change often. Free tools mentioned in this course — including a free design tool, a free AI chat tool where available, Meta Business Suite, and free video editors such as CapCut, InShot and VN Editor — may change what they give away. Verify the current limits before you build a paid service on top of any tool.

Last updated: September 2026. Questions or corrections: use the contact address supplied with your purchase.

What is inside this course

01 · Which local Businesses Actually Need This, and Which Do Not 8
02 · The Audit: Your Free Foot in the Door 13
03 · Content Strategy That Fits a Small local Business 19
04 · The Content Calendar and the Content Bank 24
05 · Mobile-First, Low-Data Production 29
06 · Captions, Graphics and Short Video That Get Engagement 35
07 · Telegram, the Underrated Channel 41
08 · Reporting and Retention 47
09 · Packages and Pricing in Dollars 52
10 · Prospecting, Outreach and Onboarding 58

HOW TO WORK THROUGH THIS COURSE

Skim the section dividers first so you can see the whole route. Then work one section at a time and finish the **DO** tasks before moving to the next. The scripts, templates and checklists are meant to be copied, filled in and sent — not admired.